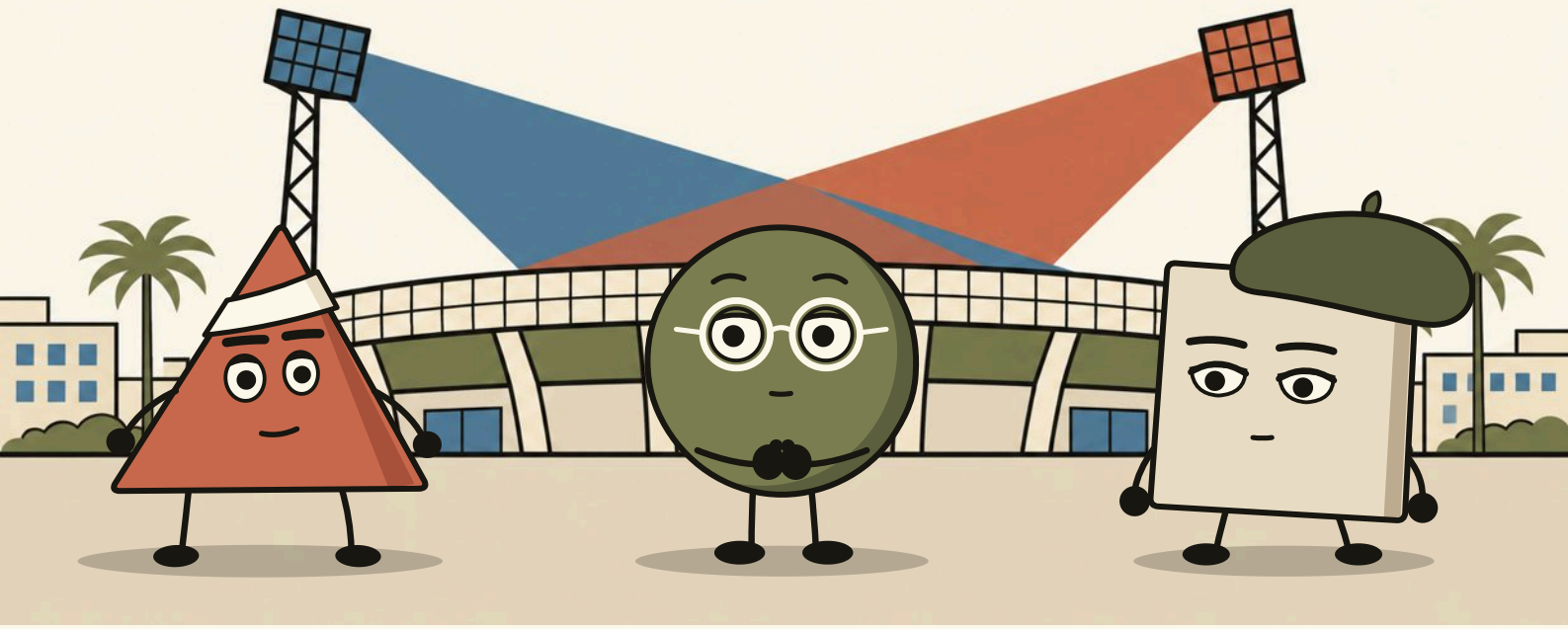
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STUDY REPORT
NOVEMBER 2026

Al Hilal and Al Nassr.

Online attention to two Riyadh clubs, January 2022 to November 2026. Nineteen findings, each tested against its strongest rival explanation.



ABSTRACT

Two stars arrived. Only one window stands clear of the calendar.

We measured online attention to Al Hilal and Al Nassr on nine public rulers and tested nineteen candidate findings, each against its strongest competing explanation.

12.09×

Al Nassr's Arabic Wikipedia page in the 30 days from Ronaldo's announcement, against its baseline

4 to 1

Al Hilal's follower lead in January 2022, reversed by June 2023

2 of 19

Findings that fail their test, kept here with their method

Data. Follower tables from three publishers, daily Wikipedia page views in Arabic, English and Spanish, Google search estimates in Saudi Arabia and six countries abroad, one frozen set of the clubs' Instagram posts read on 2 November 2026, vendor audience samples, reported home crowds, replies from two AI assistants and published brand figures. A private calendar of match days served as a control. No result was used.

Results. The sharpest dated change in either club's record is the 30 days from Ronaldo's announcement on 30 December 2022: 12.09 times the page's Arabic baseline and 15.59 times its English one, first among 49 Arabic and 47 English signing windows and first among calendar stretches with a like mix of match days. Neymar's month does not stand clear of Al Hilal's other busy stretches in Arabic. The follower order reversed on Instagram, TikTok and Facebook, while Al Hilal led on X in every comparison observed. What remained afterwards depends on the ruler. Two claims fail: that readers came for the club or for the star, and that Ronaldo's arrival lifted Al Hilal.

Conclusion. These are dated associations in attention. No finding measures a cause, a count of people or money.

THE NINETEEN VERDICTS

Fourteen findings hold, eleven of them narrowly. Two fail.

Each row is one finding, in the study's own numbering. The column is the verdict its test reached.

	Holds	Narrowly	Case or limit	Fails
1 Ronaldo's window is the sharpest jump		●		
2 Neymar's week has two layers		●		
3 The follower order flipped		●		
4 Al Nassr is the odd club on X		●		
5 What stays depends on the ruler		●		
6 Arabic and English disagree on the year out		●		
7 Whose audience it is				●
8 Ronaldo lifted Al Hilal				●
9 Biggest month differs by language		●		
10 Ronaldo leads nine moves on count		●		
11 Two TikTok samples differ		●		
12 Crowds doubled before the announcement		●		
13 Journeys are told, not counted			●	
14 Two arrival films differ on screen		●		
15 Club and country marks on one screen	●			
16 Top post is the star's arrival	●			
17 Rankings and money do not join			●	
18 The press used the star as the door			●	
19 Al assistants name both clubs	●			

Holds: the reading survives its test as stated. Holds narrowly: it survives with a named qualification. Cases or a limit: the evidence shows that something exists, or shows what the data cannot measure. Fails: the claim does not survive.

HOW TO READ THIS STUDY

Three labels, two colours, one rule about causes.

The labels

M **Measured**

A source reports the figure. We read it from a saved file and did not audit it.

E **Estimate**

A provider's model, such as Google search volumes through DataForSEO.

D **Derived**

Our arithmetic on measured or estimated figures, with its script and inputs saved.

The colours

Al Hilal is Dusty blue and Al Nassr is Terracotta in every chart. Olive marks a level reading or a measure that belongs to neither club. Stone marks the comparison clubs.

The rule about causes

A rise that coincides with a signing "went with" it. The study never says a signing "caused" a rise, because unveilings, matches and other arrivals share every window and no untouched comparison club exists.

What is left out on purpose

Match results, trophies, league positions, ownership, disputes, and youth and women's squads. The calendar of match days is used only as a dated control. Followers are accounts, never people. The study advises no club.



THE DATES AT THE JUMPS

Nine dated moments, each with its picture.



30 Dec 2022. Ronaldo announced. 32.6M likes, the most-liked Al Nassr post we read.



3 Jan 2023. Unveiled in Riyadh. 18.1M followers on 4 January, from 5.4M on 29 December.



19 Jan 2023. The Riyadh match: the top worldwide Google day of the window, ahead of the signing.



1 Aug 2023. Mane joins. Al Nassr's biggest Arabic month began the day before, at 17,184 views a day.



15 Aug 2023. Neymar signs. 10.9M likes, the most-liked Al Hilal post we read.



18 Aug 2023. He lands in Riyadh. Al Hilal's Instagram read 6.44M on the 17th, from 4.57M on the 12th.



30 May 2024. A trick in training. 13.6M likes, Al Nassr's second-biggest post, with no match in it.



28 Jan 2025. Neymar leaves. Over the latest year Al Hilal's search abroad is lower in all six countries read.



19 May 2025. Al Nassr's round crest arrives, more than two years after Ronaldo.

Instagram posts as the clubs published them, likes and comments as the frozen set of 2 November 2026 holds them, so older posts have had longer to collect them. Followers: Blinkfire, and CrowdTangle through Globo. Dates: the study's timeline.



PART ONE: METHOD

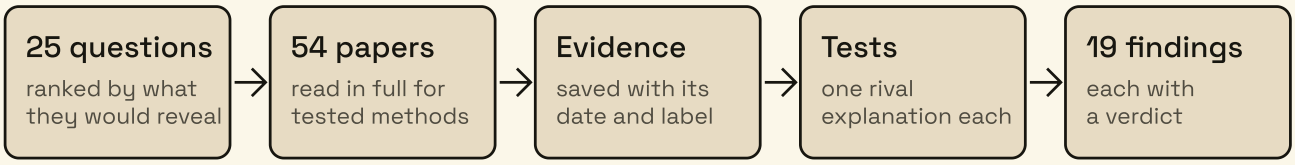
The rulers.

Nine public rulers measure attention to the two clubs, and they do not agree. The method sets them side by side and tests each reading before it is believed.

RESEARCH DESIGN

Questions first, then reading, then a test for every finding.

The study asked what each club's big signing did to its attention, what remained afterwards, and whose audience it is. It did not ask who wins on the pitch.



A counter-review attacked the findings again before the stance was written

The route from questions to verdicts. Each finding carries an observation, a competing explanation, the test run against it and a verdict.

Twenty-five questions were written and ranked by what each would reveal before any finding was drafted. The field was then read: 54 published papers in full, on club followers, star signings, attendance and search, so that each test could borrow a method that had been used before. Evidence was saved with its read date and label, and the study's own arithmetic was scripted so that every figure can be rebuilt.

Every candidate finding then met its strongest competing explanation. A signing window was compared with match days, with other busy stretches, with the league's other clubs and with history. A counter-review attacked the findings again before the stance was written. Where a reading did not survive, it was withdrawn and is reported here as a negative result.

Scope

Two clubs, studied at equal depth: Al Hilal and Al Nassr. Two league clubs, Al Ittihad and Al Ahli, are the same-week controls. Inter Miami, Juventus, Paris Saint-Germain and Real Madrid are read as comparisons for other star moves, not as controls. All dates are 2022 to 2 November 2026. Nothing was bought for this report and nothing new was pulled: every figure comes from the study's saved files.

WHAT EARLIER STUDIES FOUND

The field offers no formula for winning online, and three open disputes.

Fifty-four papers were read in full. None measures these two clubs' brands. These are the results the tests leaned on.

Question	What was found	Study
What sets a club's follower count?	Market size, history, spending and results fit follower stocks at about .80 within sample. Stars were not in the models	Scelles et al. 2017
Is a big following an engaged one?	Across 20 Spanish clubs, followers and total interactions correlate at .994, and followers and engagement per follower at −.080, not significant	Ballesteros-Herencia 2021
Does posting more raise engagement?	Not shown. Effects depend on platform, purpose and format	Romero-Jara et al. 2023, 2024
Do stars build the club or themselves?	A star as role model goes with team identification at a beta of .233. A star fits awareness and image better than loyalty	Högele et al. 2014; Pifer et al. 2015
Does a star's effect on crowds last?	One marquee player's attendance coefficient reads 1.028 in his first season, then .422, .181, .012, .107 and −.010	Jewell 2017
Did Ronaldo raise Saudi crowds?	About 20 points of capacity at his club's home games. Away and league-wide effects do not hold across specifications	Schreyer and Singleton 2024
Is search a measure of fans?	Search is neither viewing, loyalty nor money. The Saudi league's global search rose from small bases	Mutz 2024

How we read them

Each paper was read in full and noted with the table or page each figure comes from. A claim made only in an abstract was not used as a finding. Where papers disagree, the dispute is kept open, not settled by choice.

THE DATA

Fifteen sources, each with its date and its label.

Source	What it measures	Period read	Label
CIES Football Observatory	Followers of the world's top clubs	Jun 2023, Jun 2024, Jun 2025, May 2026	Measured
Result Sports	Followers across up to 22 channels	Jan 2022	Measured
Football Benchmark	Monthly follower curve, a chart with no export	Dec 2022 to Jan 2025	Measured, read by eye
Blinkfire; CrowdTangle via Globo	Daily followers around each signing	Dec 2022 to Jan 2023; Aug 2023	Measured
Wikimedia	Daily page views in three languages	2015 to Oct 2026	Measured
Google, through DataForSEO	Search volumes and relative interest	Nov 2022 to Sep 2026	Estimate
Instagram, frozen set	Likes and comments per club post	Read 2 Nov 2026	Measured
TikTok audience samples	Country labels of sampled followers	Read 2 Nov 2026	Measured counts
Wikipedia match pages	Reported home crowds	2021-22 and 2022-23	Measured
ChatGPT and Gemini	Whether a reply names each club	Fixed questions, three repeats	Derived
Brand Finance; club accounts; the league	Brand indices, revenue, advertising value	2023 to 2025	Measured
The world's press	How articles introduce each club	2022 and 2023	Measured
Ministry of Tourism; DataSaudi	Inbound visitors, all purposes	2022 and 2024	Measured, estimate
Club and promotional films	What is on screen, frame by frame	2022 to 2025	Derived from frames
A private match calendar	Match days, used as a control	1,009 rows	Control only

MEASURES AND CONTROLS

Each multiple is a window against its own page's baseline.

A page that usually draws a few views can show a large multiple from a small rise, so counts and multiples are always read together.

1 **Baseline**

The median of daily page views from 37 to 8 days before an event. The gap keeps rumours and early reports out of the base.

2 **Window multiple**

The mean of daily views over the 30 days from the event, divided by the baseline. A 28-day ruler is used where nine world moves are compared.

3 **Like stretches**

Every other 30-day stretch of the club's history with about the same mix of match days on the private calendar. The window is ranked among them.

4 **Share of edition**

A page's views as a share of all views in its Wikipedia edition. It holds out the edition's own growth and changes in how Wikimedia counts traffic.

5 **Same-week controls**

Al Ittihad and Al Ahli read over the same dates. A rise shared by all four clubs is not given to one club's signing.

6 **The frozen feed**

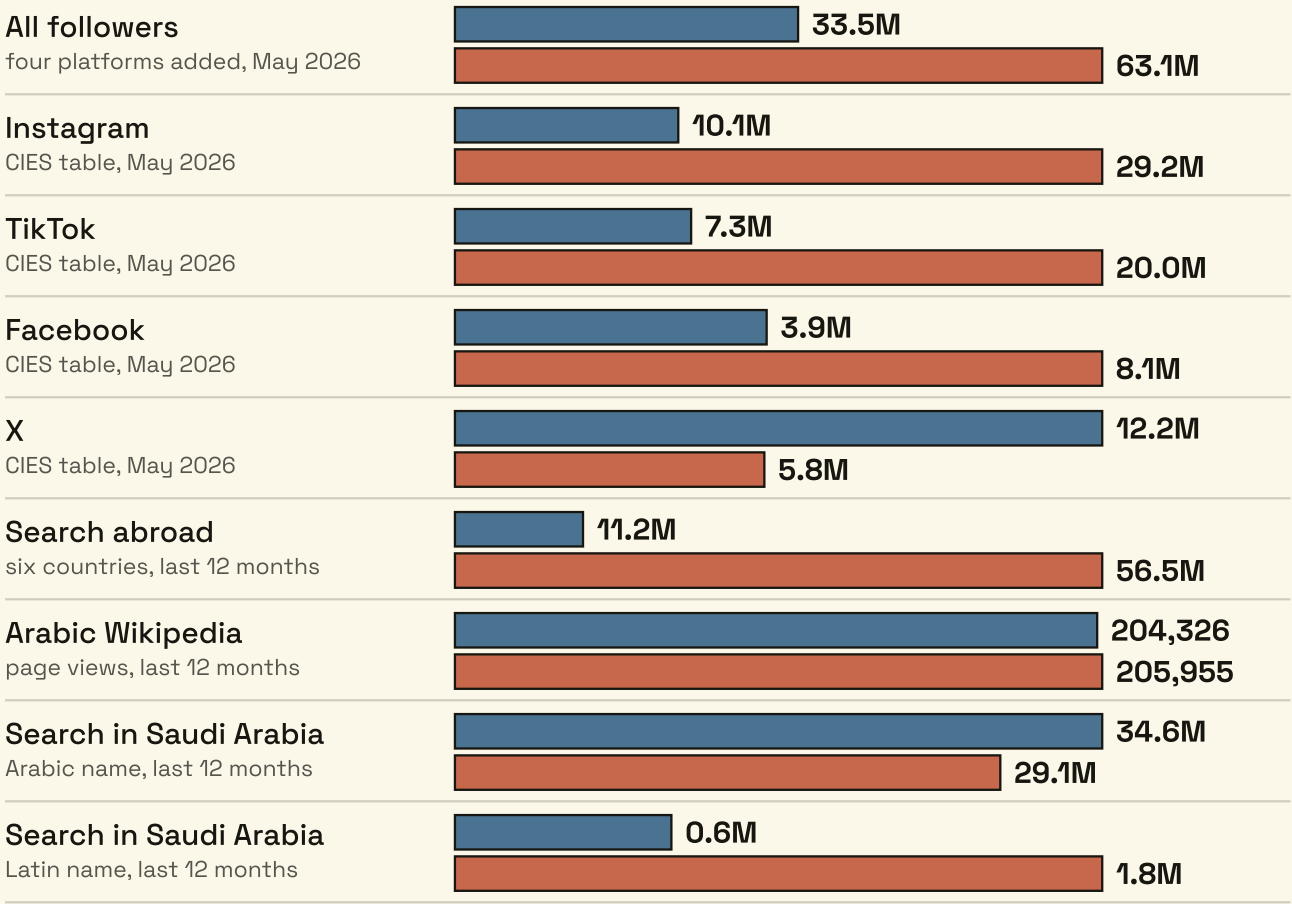
Every post on each club's Instagram, read once at 07:45 UTC on 2 November 2026: photos back to December 2022, videos back to 2014. Likes are counted as they stand that day.

Why a calendar and not results

Form could lift attention by itself. The private calendar dates each match so that windows with a like mix of match days can be compared. No score or outcome enters any test or any page of this report.

Al Nassr leads every global ruler except X. At home the two are close.

Nine rulers, each on its own scale. Blue is Al Hilal and terracotta Al Nassr.



How we know

Followers are CIES's May 2026 table as reported (measured). Search figures are Google's estimates through DataForSEO for one fixed name form (estimate), and the sums are ours (derived). Page views are Wikimedia's own counts (measured). Followers are accounts, and a fan on two platforms counts twice.



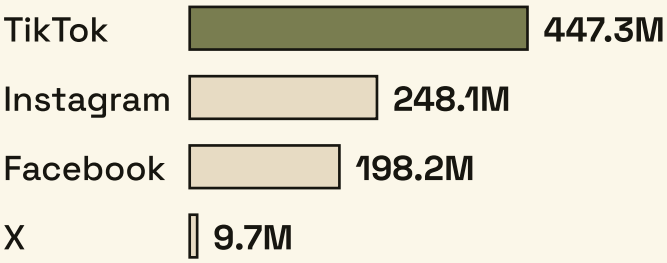
Football Benchmark, season 2023-24. The 20 clubs that gained the most followers, 1 July 2023 to 1 July 2024. Al Nassr gained 19.8M and Al Hilal 10.8M. Their table, their figures.

Football Benchmark and Ace Advisory, KORE data by their stated method.

THE TIDE UNDER BOTH CLUBS

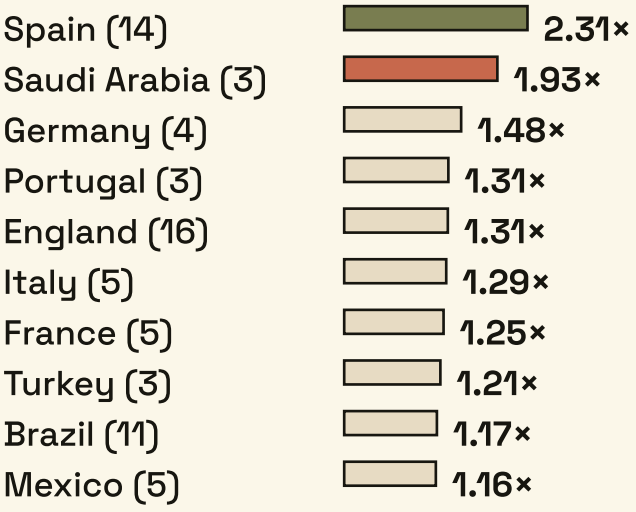
Most large clubs grew, and the growth is slowing.

Two clubs cannot show what moves a follower count, so 88 clubs in CIES's tables of both 2023 and 2026 frame them. Their combined gain came mostly from TikTok.

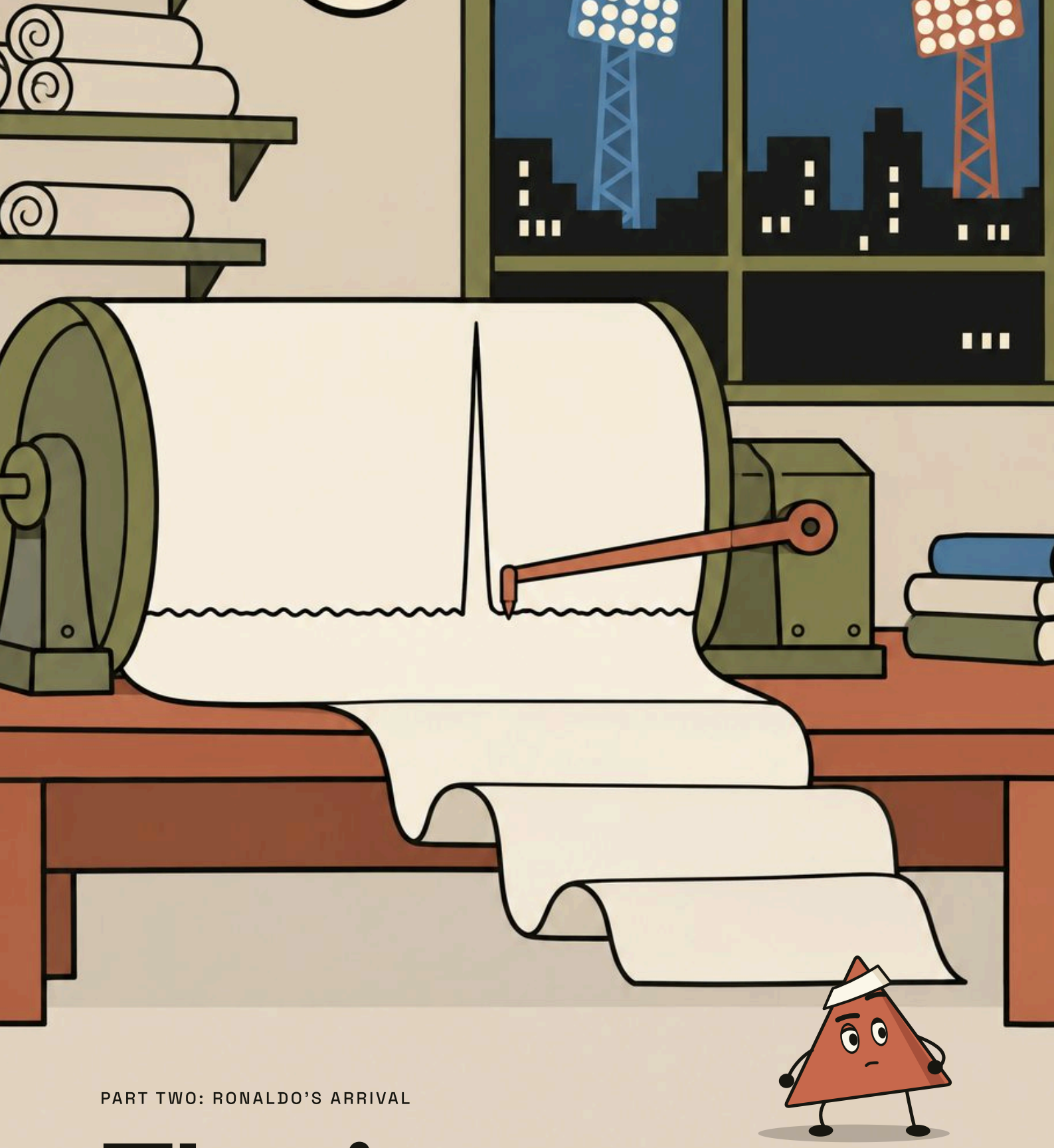


Followers gained by the 88 clubs, June 2023 to May 2026, by platform.

The median club grew 13.1% from 2023 to 2024, 7.9% to 2025 and 3.6% to 2026. Saudi Arabia's three listed clubs grew a median 1.93 times, second to Spain.



Median follower growth by league, 2023 to 2026, leagues with three clubs or more. Our sums of CIES's tables (derived); the panel holds only clubs already large.



PART TWO: RONALDO'S ARRIVAL

The jump.

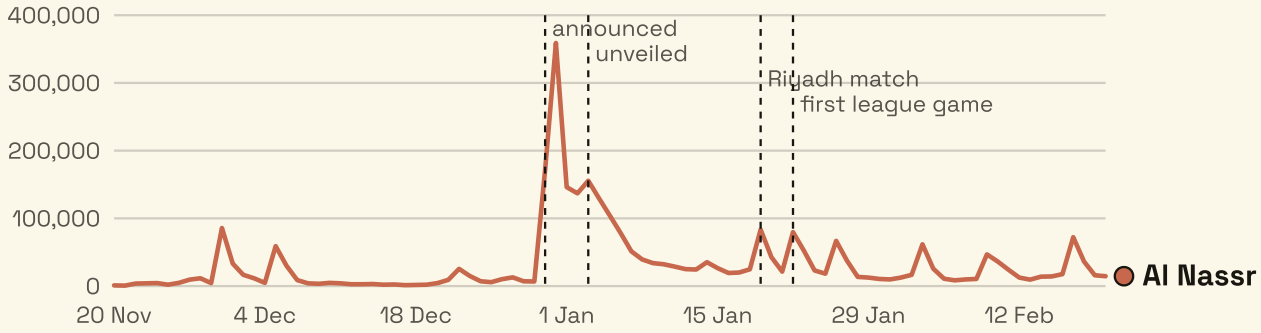
The 30 days from Ronaldo's announcement are the sharpest rise in either club's attention record. The calendar comparisons we hold do not explain them.

FINDING 1: OBSERVATION

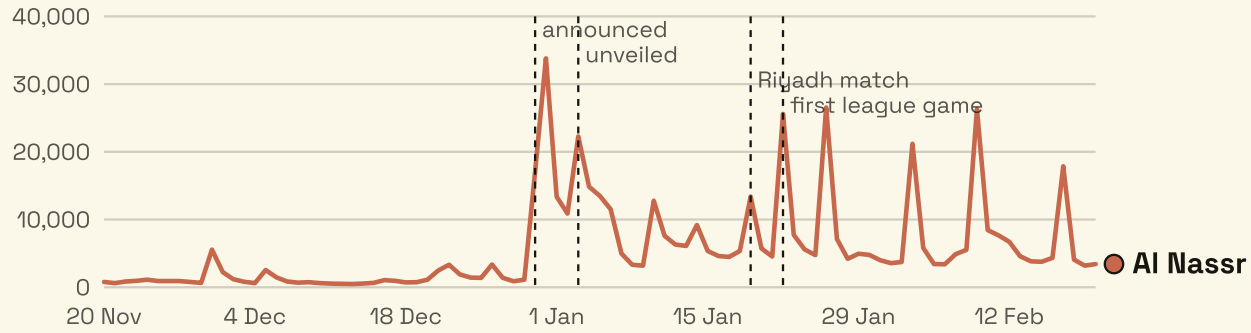
Al Nassr's page views jumped in both languages within days.

Daily views of Al Nassr's Wikipedia page, 20 November 2022 to 20 February 2023. The dashed lines are the four dated events inside the window.

English edition



Arabic edition



5.4M

Al Nassr's followers on five platforms, 29 December 2022

18.1M

The same count on 4 January 2023, six days later

32.6M

Likes on the club's launch post, read 2 November 2026

How we know

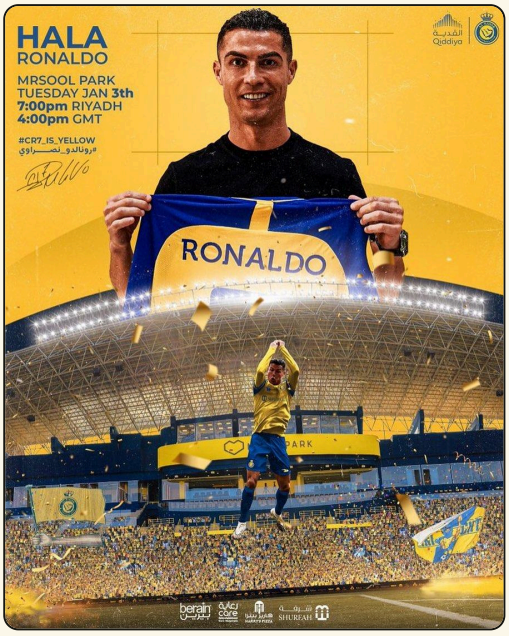
Page views are Wikimedia's daily counts (measured). Followers are Blinkfire's (measured); its own stated gain is 12.6 million while its rounded endpoints give 12.7 million. The launch post is co-authored with the player, so its likes are shared.

FINDING 1: THE WEEK ITSELF

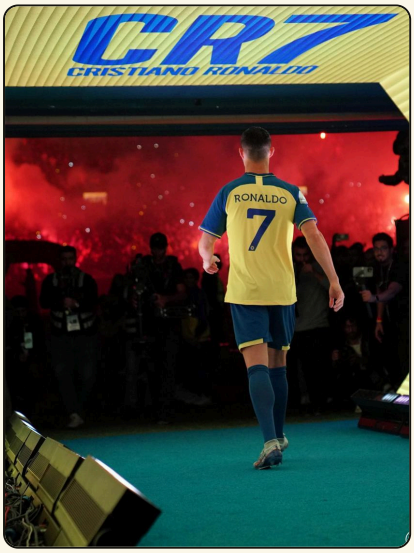
The posts that carried the arrival.



30 December 2022. 32,575,027 likes, 1,190,563 comments. The launch post, 381 times the median Al Nassr post on file. He is its co-author, so the count is shared. The largest post before it on file holds 184,925.



2 January 2023. 3,558,400 likes. The poster for the unveiling.



3 January. 3,249,664 likes. The tunnel with his name on it.



3 January. 3,159,484 likes. The shirt in the dressing room.



4 January. 4,289,714 likes. Alone on the pitch in training kit.

Al Nassr's Instagram. Instagram posts as the clubs published them, likes and comments as the frozen set of 2 November 2026 holds them, so older posts have had longer to collect them. The club official beside him is named in no caption and stays unnamed here.

FINDING 1: THE FORM TEST

A match day moves the page about twice. The window moved it twelve to fifteen times.

The competing explanation is that attention follows the team's form. So the window was ranked among every 30-day stretch with about the same mix of match days.

Arabic page

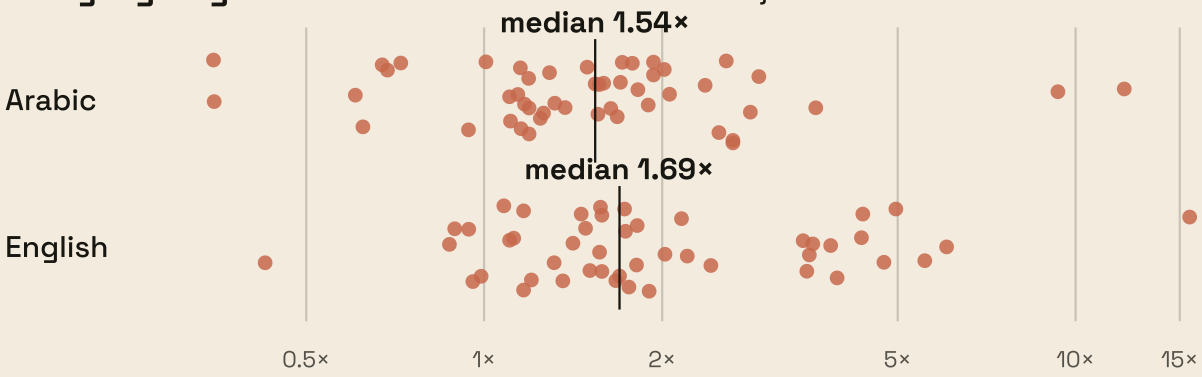
Ronaldo's 30 days	12.09×
Largest like stretch	4.02×
A match day	1.93×

English page

Ronaldo's 30 days	15.59×
Largest like stretch	6.23×
A match day	1.73×

Multiples of the page's baseline. "Largest like stretch" is the highest of 190 Arabic and 181 English 30-day stretches with a similar calendar. Ronaldo's window ranks first in both.

Every signing window at the four Saudi clubs, one dot each



Thirty-day multiples for 49 Arabic and 47 English signing windows, on a log scale. The median window reads 1.54 times in Arabic and 1.69 in English. Only 4% and 6% reach five times. Ronaldo's window is the right-most dot in both rows.

FINDING 1: FOUR FURTHER ATTACKS

The window survives history, the World Cup and the league.

Attack	What was done	Result
Unreadable dates	Stretches whose match dates could not be read were allowed back in	Still first: 5.16 times in Arabic, 6.23 in English. Four of its own five dated matches are readable
History	Every 30-day window from every daily start since 2015	3rd of 3,944 in Arabic, its neighbours being the same days. 80th of 3,553 in English, behind a 2020 episode of 28.84 times from a base of 22 views a day
World Cup in the base	Baseline ended on 19 November 2022, before the tournament	The multiples grow to 17.14 in Arabic and 149.95 in English
League-wide rise	The mean of Al Ittihad's and Al Ahli's same-window multiples taken off	8.80 points remain in Arabic and 12.75 in English. A shared rise is real and is not the whole of it
Google's top day	The saved worldwide daily index across the window	Peaks on 19 January 2023, the Riyadh match, not on the signing

The English window's mean is 69,353 views a day, against 22 for the 2020 episode that outranks it. In Arabic it is the sharpest rise and not the largest month: that is 31 July to 29 August 2023, at 17,184 views a day against this window's 10,522 (Finding 9).

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> A dated jump in attention, the sharpest in the study, which the calendar comparisons do not explain. They cannot exclude a star and a strong run arriving together, and the comparison stretches overlap. What the signing alone caused stays unknown: the unveiling, the Riyadh match and the debut share the window.

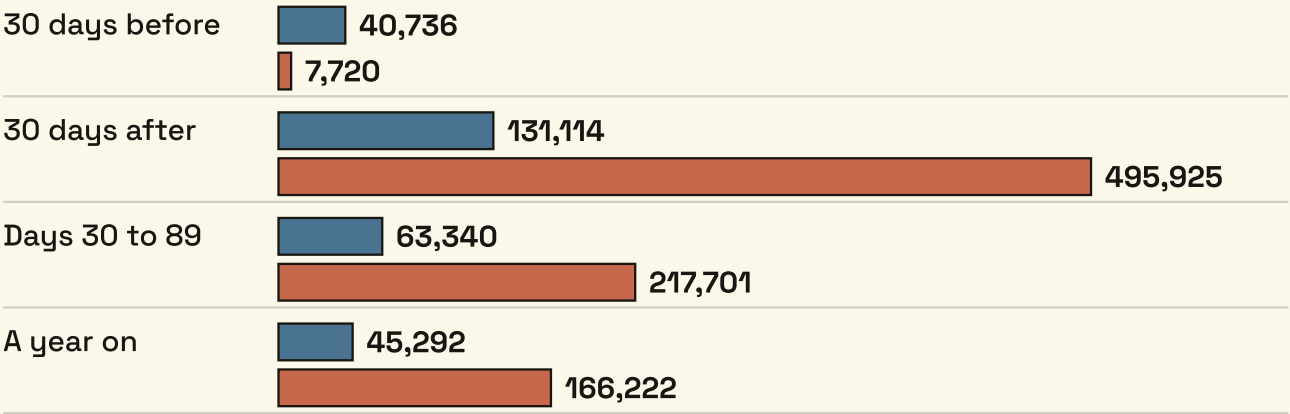


19 January 2023. 4,257,668 likes. Al Nassr's post from the Riyadh match, the window's top day on worldwide Google. Its caption stays off this page.

FINDING 16: THE FEED

The typical Al Nassr post went from 7,720 likes to 495,925.

Median likes per post on each club's Instagram, in four windows around its star's arrival. Read once, on 2 November 2026.



Blue is Al Hilal around Neymar's signing on 15 August 2023. Terracotta is Al Nassr around Ronaldo's on 30 December 2022. Each window holds 137 to 359 posts.

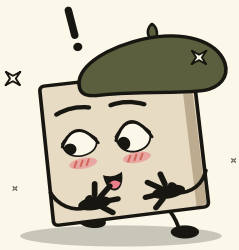
43 of 50

Al Nassr's top posts by likes that name, tag or share authorship with Ronaldo

42 of 50

Al Hilal's top posts that do the same with Neymar

A year on, Al Nassr's typical post sits about 21 times where it started. Al Hilal's sits about 1.1 times, in weeks when Neymar was out. None of Al Nassr's top 50 posts predates its signing, and one of Al Hilal's does.



FINDING 16: THE TEST

The top posts hold. Al Hilal's year-on reading is a near tie.

Club	Top post	Likes	Times the median post	Largest post before the signing
Al Nassr	Launch post, 30 Dec 2022	32,575,027	381	184,925
Al Hilal	Signing photo, 15 Aug 2023	10,868,591	454	1,185,147

Competing explanations. Counters are read today, so old posts have had longer and later followers can like them. The launch posts name the star as co-author, so his followers count too. A median over few posts moves easily.

Test. Age runs the other way for the before window: it has had longest and still reads lowest. Co-authorship is real and marked. Adding the photo and carousel posts moved the reading. Before they landed, Al Hilal's year-on median sat a little below its start, 45,292 against 49,399. Now it sits a little above, 45,292 against 40,736. Al Nassr's before window fell from 16,084 on 15 videos to 7,720 on 137 posts, so its multiple about doubled. Six posts held twice under two identifiers now count once.

> VERDICT: HOLDS
>
> The most-liked post on each club's feed is its star's arrival, on likes as they stand today and not at the time. The sharp rise and fall-back of the median holds at both clubs. How far Al Hilal's typical post stands from its start a year on does not stand as a finding.

How we know

Derived from vendor counters as the frozen set holds them. The share of top posts naming a star comes from captions, tags and co-authors, not from what each picture shows. A photo post older than December 2022 is unread.

FINDING 16: WHAT TRAVELLED FURTHEST

Four of Al Nassr's twelve most-liked posts are a man at ease.

A trick in training, a cat, an Eid greeting and a hello, likes as read on 2 November 2026. All twelve of the club's most-liked posts name, tag or co-author Ronaldo.



Rank 2. 13,593,451. 30 May 2024. A trick in training.



Rank 10. 7,364,732. 2 April 2025. The cat.



Rank 11. 6,681,524. 21 April 2023. Eid Mubarak.



Rank 12. 6,385,319. 27 January 2024. Salam Alaikum.

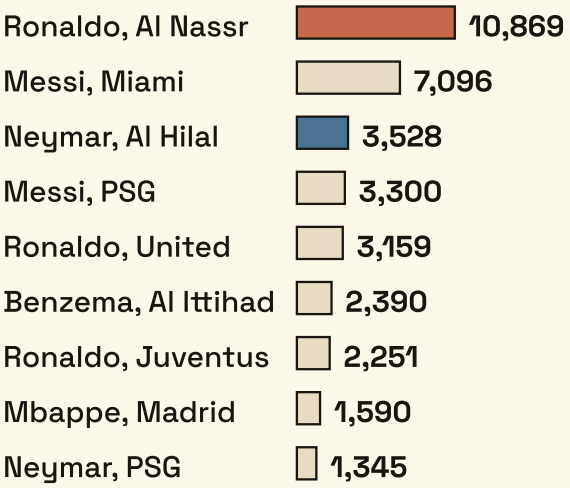
Al Nassr's Instagram, ranked by likes in the frozen set. Ranks 3 and 4 celebrate a result and rank 5, an art project, may show a young face, so they are left out. Rank 1 is the launch post.

FINDING 10: AGAINST THE WORLD'S STAR MOVES

Most Arabic page views of nine moves. Not the largest multiple.

Nine star moves on one ruler: the club's Arabic page, 28 days from the event against a 28-day baseline. A small club's multiple flatters it, and a big club's count flatters it, so both are shown.

Views a day, Arabic page



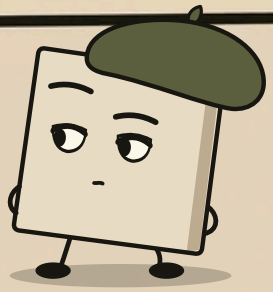
Against the club's baseline



Ronaldo's move drew 10,869 Arabic views a day, at 13.52 times its baseline, and the most Spanish views, 15,720 a day. Messi to Inter Miami holds the largest multiple, 136.78 in Arabic and 48.39 in Spanish, because it starts from about 52 views a day. Mbappe to Real Madrid reads 0.07 because its baseline holds the club's big matches, which is no verdict on that move.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> Top by count over 28 days in Arabic and Spanish among these nine moves. At 14 days Messi to Miami leads in Arabic and Messi to Paris in Spanish, and at 56 days too few moves have complete windows. English is withheld because page titles split. No worldwide "biggest" can be claimed.





PART THREE: NEYMAR'S ARRIVAL

The trap.

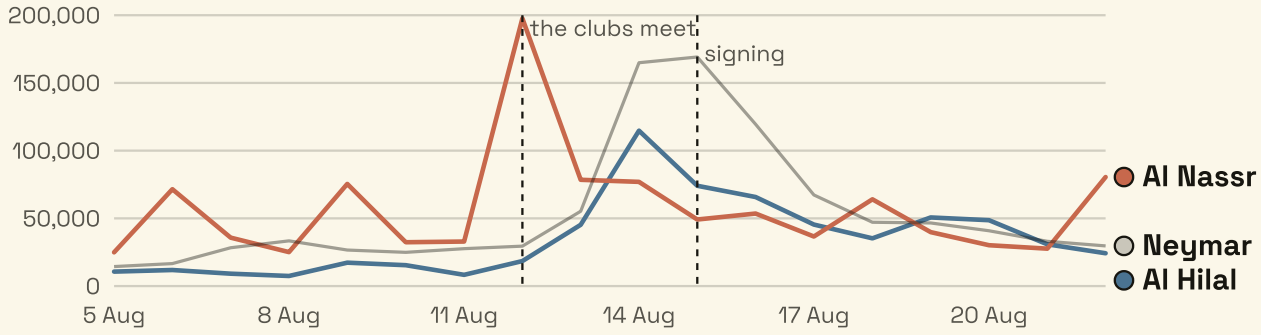
Al Hilal's line jumps three days before Neymar signed. Part of that jump is a match the two clubs played against each other, and part runs alongside talk of the move. The two cannot be separated.

FINDING 2: OBSERVATION

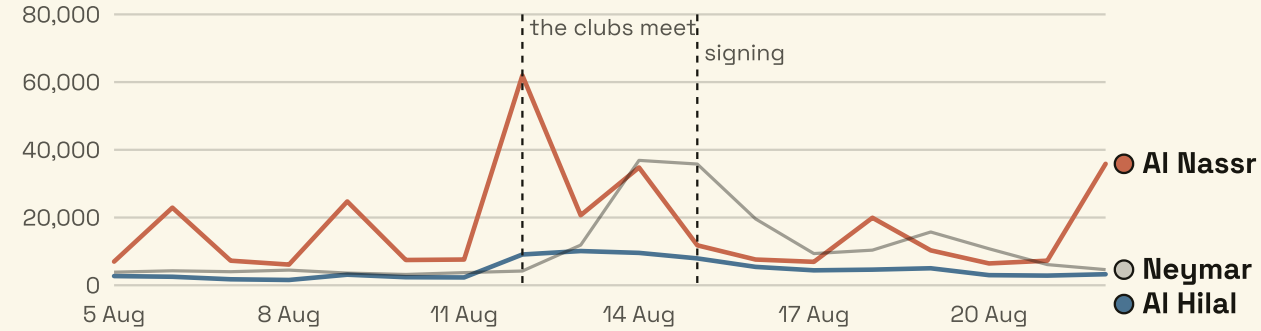
After the two clubs met, their pages went separate ways.

Daily Wikipedia views, 5 to 22 August 2023, for both clubs and for Neymar's own page. The clubs played each other on the 12th. He signed on the 15th.

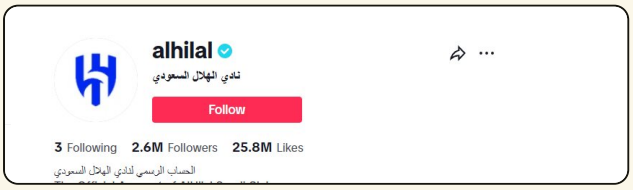
English edition



Arabic edition



On the 12th Al Nassr's Arabic page read 61,937 and Al Hilal's 9,055. On the 13th and 14th Al Nassr's fell away in both editions while Al Hilal's held in Arabic and climbed in English, peaking at 114,767 on the 14th. Neymar's own page rose with it.



3 August 2023. 2.6M followers. Al Hilal on TikTok, twelve days before the signing.



3 September 2023. 4.5M followers. Nineteen days after it. Internet Archive captures, the platform's rounded counts.

FINDING 2: THE TEST

Page views moved first. Followers moved on the day it was official.

Page, against 12 August	13 Aug, Arabic	14 Aug, Arabic	13 Aug, English	14 Aug, English
Al Nassr	0.33×	0.56×	0.40×	0.39×
Al Hilal	1.11×	1.06×	2.46×	6.24×
Neymar	2.83×	8.79×	1.88×	5.61×

Competing explanation. The whole rise is the afterglow of that match, and no transfer talk is needed to explain it.

Test. After the match the two clubs' paths diverged, alongside growth on Neymar's own page and dated transfer reporting. The earliest dated report in the saved press, ge on 13 August, names Al Hilal as his probable next club. Al Hilal's Instagram read 4.57 million on the 12th, 4.82 million on the 14th, 5.96 million on the 15th and 6.44 million on the 17th. On the 13th and 14th the club posted 17 times and named or tagged him in none.

Form. In English this 30-day window ranks 1st of 174 stretches with a fully dated calendar, 2.42 times against a largest 2.10, but 16th of 293 once undated stretches are allowed. In Arabic it ranks 21st of 174 and 49th of 293.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> On 13 and 14 August the clubs' page paths diverge alongside Neymar's page and dated transfer reporting, and their separate contributions remain unknown. Across the whole month, this signing does not stand clear of the club's other busy stretches the way Ronaldo's does.

The arrival on Al Hilal's Instagram, likes as read on 2 November 2026



15 Aug 2023. 10,868,591. The signing.



15 Aug. 4,890,964. "Bem vindo".



18 Aug. 5,384,995. The steps.



3 Sep. 3,930,334. The third shirt.

FINDING 9: THE BIGGEST MONTHS

In English the biggest month is the star's arrival. In Arabic it is football.

Each club's five largest non-overlapping 30-day stretches, by views a day. A coloured bar is a star's arrival.

Al Hilal, English

Aug 2023 Neymar	31,090
Jul 2023	13,875
Sep 2023	13,407
Jun 2025 tournament	9,098
Dec 2023	7,958

Al Nassr, English

Dec 2022 Ronaldo	69,353
Aug 2023 Mane, cup	53,751
Feb 2023	31,742
Sep 2023	29,950
Oct 2023	25,647

Al Hilal, Arabic

Apr 2024 Neymar out	7,202
Nov 2019	6,591
Feb 2023 tournament	6,390
Apr 2019	4,466
Aug 2023 Neymar	4,299

Al Nassr, Arabic

Jul 2023 Mane, cup	17,184
Sep 2023	12,179
Oct 2023	11,270
Dec 2022 Ronaldo	10,522
Feb 2023	10,052

In English, Al Nassr's top stretch begins on 30 December 2022 at 69,353 views a day and Al Hilal's on 9 August 2023 at 31,090. In Arabic, Al Nassr's top stretch begins on 31 July 2023, as Mane arrived and the Arab Club Champions Cup ran, with Ronaldo's window fourth. Al Hilal's begins on 7 April 2024, inside Neymar's year out, with the Neymar weeks fifth.

FINDING 9: THE TEST

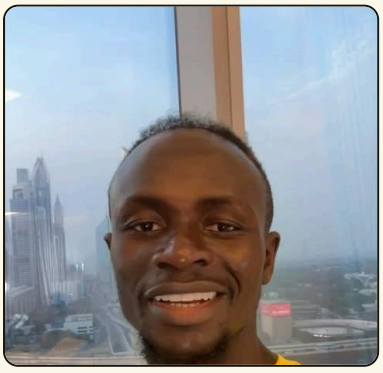
Raw views reversed an earlier claim. The split between languages held.

A counter-review asked whether a multiple is an audience. So every stretch was re-read in raw views and as a share of its edition.

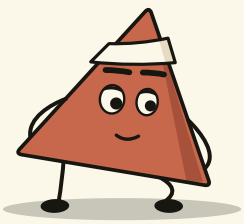
Arabic edition	Stretch	Views per million in the edition
Al Nassr	From 31 July 2023, football and arrivals	2,397
Al Nassr	From 30 December 2022, Ronaldo	1,385
Al Hilal	From 7 April 2024, football	961
Al Hilal	From August 2023, Neymar	600

An earlier version of this finding said Al Hilal's biggest English month was a tournament, because its June 2025 multiple reads 5.23 times against Neymar's 2.42. On raw views that stretch is fourth, at 9,098 views a day against Neymar's 31,090. The larger multiple came from a far lower base, and the claim was withdrawn. On multiples, a football month reaches 0.25 and 0.14 of Ronaldo's.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> The split between the editions is clear on page views. The Arabic months still hold star players, so this says where the top months fall, not that football outweighs a star. Whether a tournament's attention differs in kind from a signing's cannot be told from volume and timing.



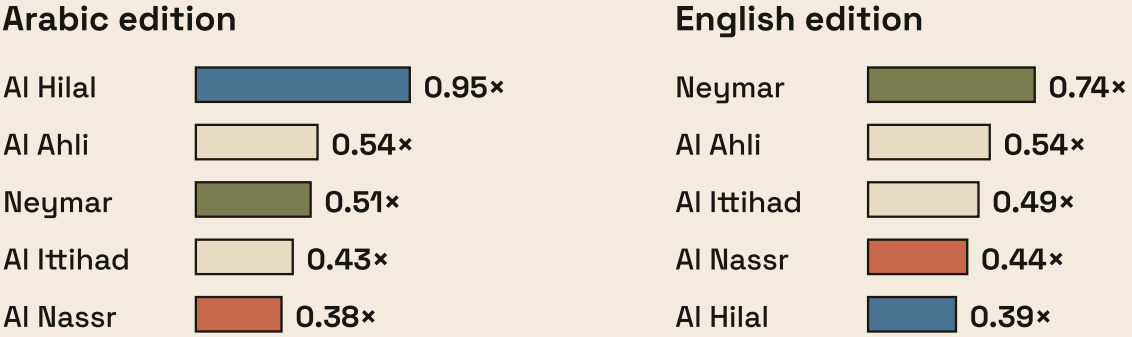
1 August 2023. 2,901,988 likes. Mane joins Al Nassr, the day after its biggest Arabic stretch began.



FINDING 6: NEYMAR'S YEAR OUT

In Arabic the club held while his page halved. In English the order reverses.

Share of each Wikipedia edition from 17 October 2023 to 20 October 2024, the dates of his absence from official notices, against a baseline of 10 September to 9 October 2023.



Competing explanations. The baseline month was unusually busy; the club's match days fill the absence and hold its share up; a year spans too many other events to read at all.

Test. Moving the baseline 14 days either way keeps the order in Arabic, with Al Hilal at 0.74 to 1.28 and Neymar at 0.45 to 0.66, and in English, with Al Hilal at 0.34 to 0.56 and Neymar at 0.59 to 0.73. Removing every located match day and the day after leaves Al Hilal at 0.77 in Arabic and 0.48 in English, and the other three clubs at 0.48 to 0.66 in Arabic. Wikimedia's traffic change of March 2025 falls outside the window.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY, EDITION BY EDITION
>
> "The club held and he halved" holds in Arabic only, and the club's figure moves with the baseline. It is a reading of pages, not of loyalty, and it gives no medical reading.



15 Aug 2023. 1,585,817 likes. Before the absence.



18 Oct 2024. 2,327,153 likes. With Novak Djokovic.



PART FOUR: THE ORDER

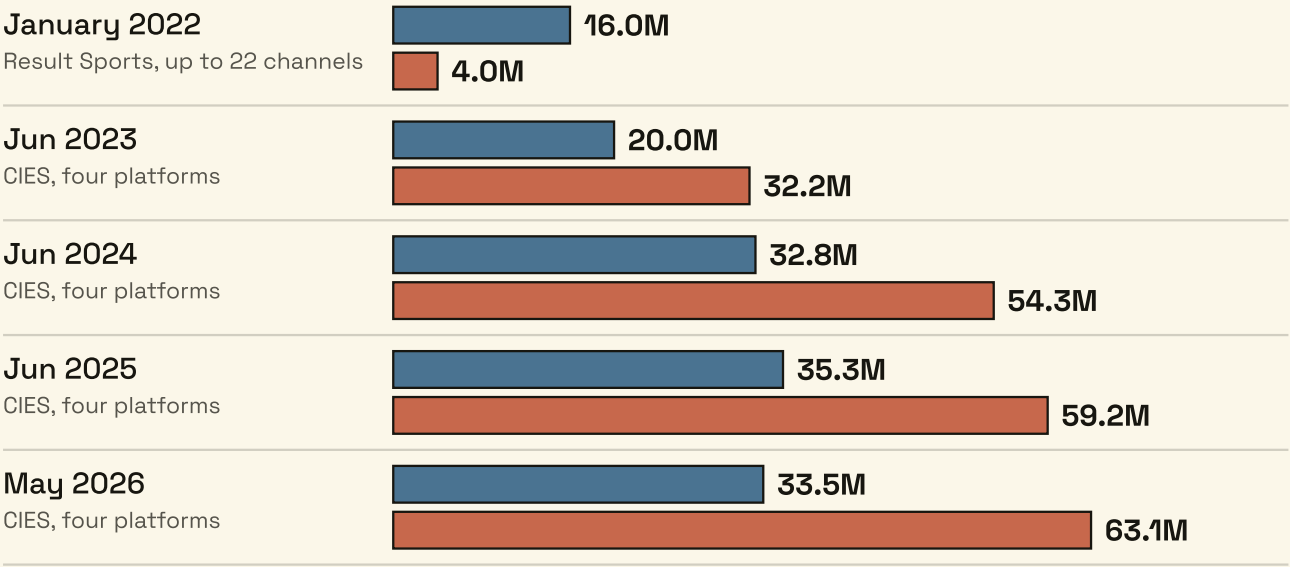
The flip.

In January 2022 Al Hilal led on followers about four to one. By June 2023 the order had reversed on three of four named platforms. X is the exception.

FINDING 3: OBSERVATION

Five snapshots, two publishers, one reversal.

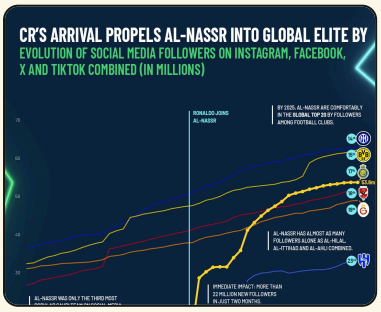
Total followers of each club in the publishers' own tables. The first row counts up to 22 channels and the rest count four platforms, so the rows are different rulers.



Result Sports placed Al Hilal 31st in its January 2022 ranking and Al Nassr 74th. CIES read 19,973,483 and 32,225,361 in June 2023. Football Benchmark's monthly curve, the only series that crosses the date, shows Al Nassr passing Al Hilal between 1 January and 1 February 2023. It reads Al Nassr at 5.2 million on 1 December 2022 and 53.6 million on 1 January 2025.

How we know

Each publisher's table as reported (measured). The crossing is read by eye from a chart with no export (derived). The two baskets differ, so no single line is drawn across them.



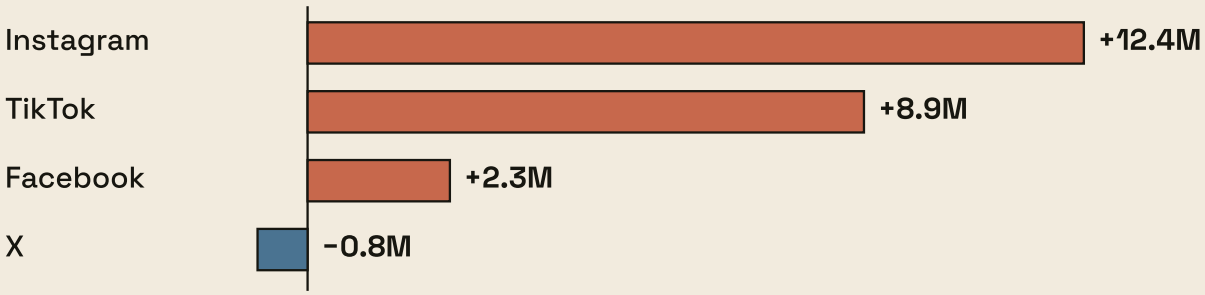
Football Benchmark, January 2025. Followers on four platforms, month by month: Al Nassr's follower line crosses Al Hilal's in January 2023. The chart's headline is the publisher's, untested as a cause.

Al Hilal's shield before August 2022, and Al Nassr's crown over roundel, the mark on the shirt at Ronaldo's signing.

FINDING 3: THE TEST

Instagram and TikTok carry 21.2 million of a 22.7 million swing.

The competing explanations: two publishers with different baskets make a false flip, or the follower jump is not real attention.

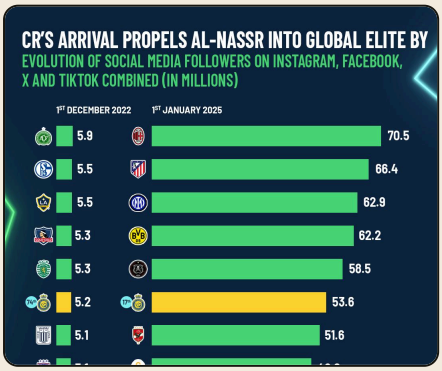


The change in each platform's gap between January 2022 and June 2023, towards Al Nassr in terracotta and towards Al Hilal in blue. Bookkeeping across two publishers, not growth on one ruler.

Facebook also flips, and X does not: Al Hilal leads X in every observed comparison. Holding the January 2022 Instagram and TikTok gaps fixed, Al Hilal would still lead by 8,979,122 on the four named platforms. That is a hypothetical, not a tested world.

On quality, the test does not settle the competing explanation. The two papers read in full say that purges and labelled account features are what would tell real accounts from spam, and the study holds neither for these clubs.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> A reversal by June 2023 on three of four named platforms, driven mainly by Instagram and TikTok. The January timing rests on one chart read by eye. Spam and changed account sets cannot be ruled in or out, and no one is accused.

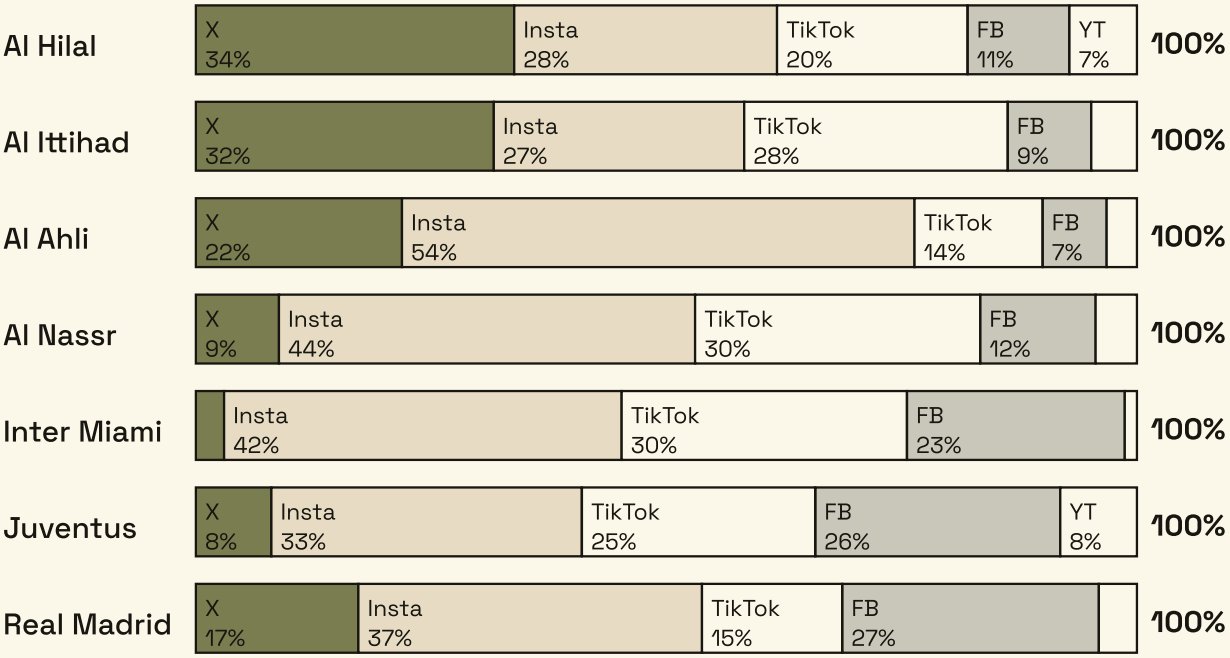


Football Benchmark, January 2025. Before and after: Al Nassr at 5.2M on 1 December 2022 and 53.6M on 1 January 2025, rounded, four platforms. Their table, their figures.

FINDING 4: THE SHAPE OF EACH CLUB

A third of a Saudi club's followers sit on X. Al Nassr is the exception.

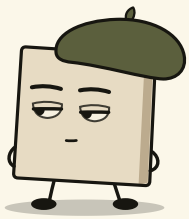
Each club's five platforms as shares of its total, CIES, May 2026. Olive is X.



X holds 33.8% of Al Hilal's total, 31.7% of Al Ittihad's and 21.9% of Al Ahli's, against 8.8% of Al Nassr's. Inter Miami reads 3.0% and Juventus 8.0%. Al Nassr's Instagram and TikTok shares, 44.2% and 30.3%, sit beside Inter Miami's 42.2% and 30.3%. Real Madrid, Barcelona and Manchester United sit at 17% to 18% on X, so a low X share is not simply what a large club looks like.

How we know

CIES's May 2026 table (measured), with the shares ours (derived). A vendor read of the main accounts on 2 November 2026 gives the same order: X 10,233,891 against 4,087,351, Instagram 10,528,836 against 30,229,698, TikTok 7,500,000 against 21,300,000.



FINDING 4: THE TEST

Account age does not explain TikTok, and cannot be measured on X.

The competing explanation is that Al Hilal simply reached X first, and an older account stacks up more followers.

Account	Al Hilal began	Al Nassr began	Who leads, and since when
X	3 April 2009	14 March 2012	Al Hilal, already 9.5 million to 3.1 million in October 2021 on Arabic accounts
TikTok	23 February 2020	18 February 2022	Al Nassr, nearly three to one, a lead formed by 3 August 2023

On TikTok the younger account leads, so age is not the whole of it there. On X both accounts are old, and any contribution from age cannot be measured from ten start dates. No other reason is found: the study holds no public age, language or nationality for any of these followers, and Inter Miami is one comparison, not a control.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY, AS A DESCRIPTION
>
> X holds about a third of Al Hilal's and Al Ittihad's followers and 9% of Al Nassr's, and Inter Miami, which also signed a global star, has similar Instagram and TikTok shares to Al Nassr's. Why stays unknown. Nothing here says the signing made the shape.

How we know

Account start dates as saved in the study's evidence (measured). October 2021 from Alyaum, Arabic accounts only (measured). The TikTok lead from an archived page of 3 August 2023 (measured).



PART FIVE: WHAT STAYS

What stays.

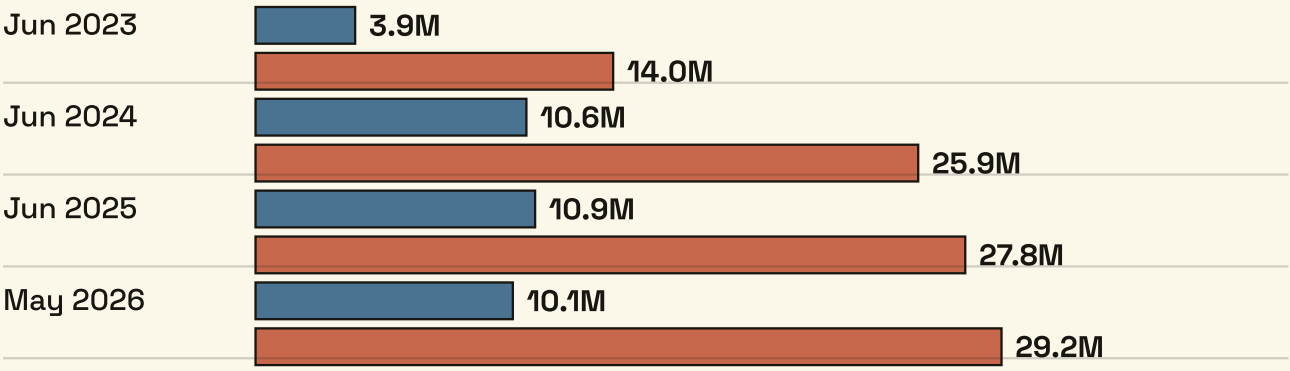
After the arrivals, four rulers give four answers. Follower totals stay high, search abroad parts ways, reading goes back, and likes rise and fall.

FINDING 5: OBSERVATION

What stays depends on the ruler you hold.

Ruler	First reading	Latest reading	Direction
Al Hilal's Instagram followers	3.9M, June 2023	10.07M, May 2026	Up, then flat
Search abroad, last 12 months against the 12 before	Al Nassr 1.15 to 1.29 times in all six countries. Al Hilal 0.31 to 0.91 times in all six		Apart
Arabic Wikipedia, share of the edition in September	Al Hilal 0.033%, Al Nassr 0.030%, 2020	Al Hilal 0.012%, Al Nassr 0.010%, 2026	Back down
Median likes per post, Al Nassr	7,812, 90 days before	45,105, last 12 months	Up, then back
Median likes per post, Al Hilal	38,853, 90 days before	13,881, last 12 months	Up, then below

Instagram followers, CIES

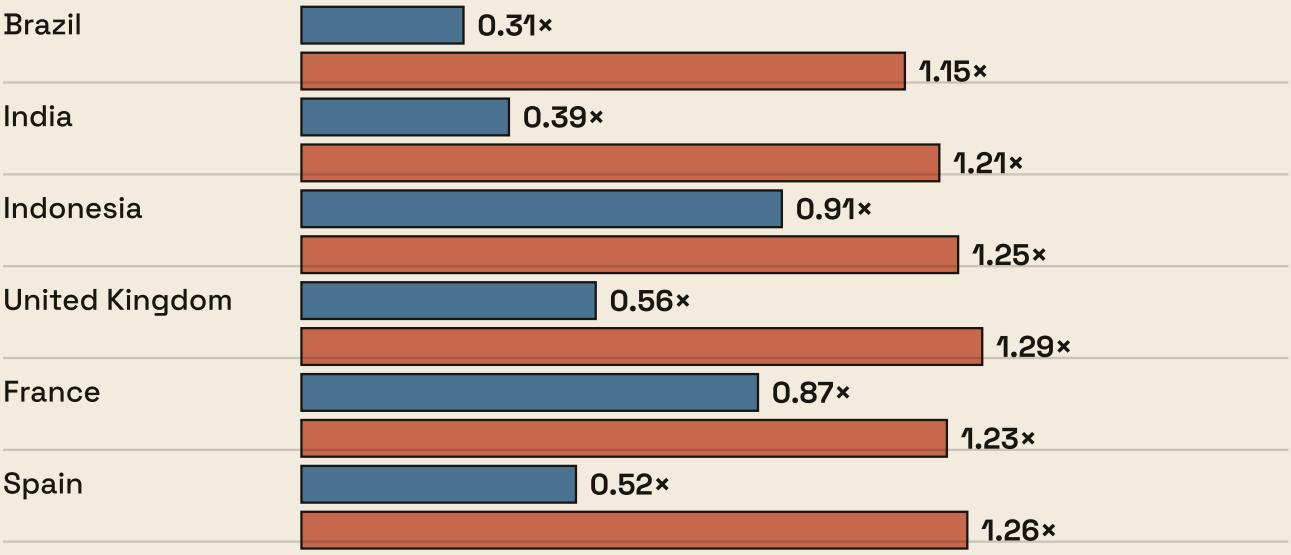


Follower totals describe an accumulated stock, not attention that was kept. Likes rise and then fall back at both clubs, ending above the start at Al Nassr and below it at Al Hilal. One star has left and the other has not.

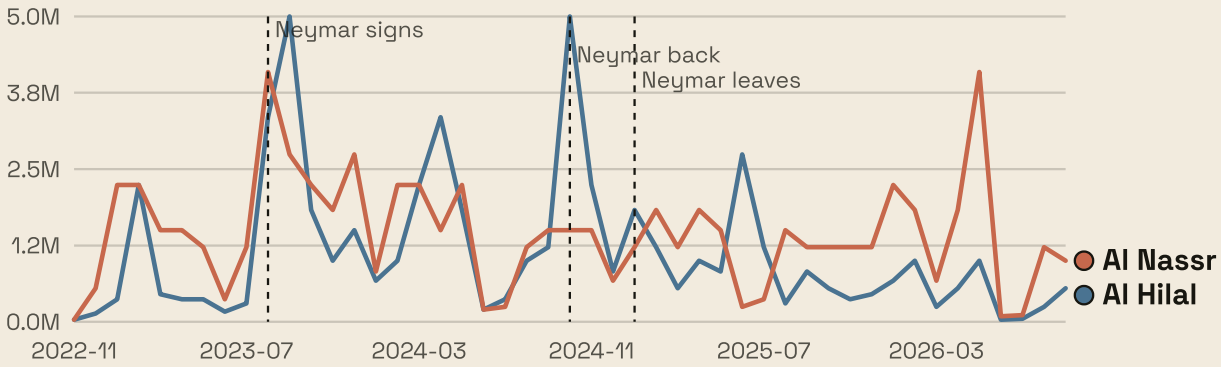
FINDING 5: SEARCH ABROAD

Over the latest year, Al Hilal's search abroad is lower in all six countries.

Google searches for "al hilal" and "al nassr" in six countries, the last 12 months against the 12 before. Below 1 is a fall.



Brazil, month by month



Al Hilal's largest month in Brazil in the earlier span is October 2024, 5,000,000, the month Neymar returned. Its largest since is 1,000,000. These are dates beside a line, and no share of the line is given to him.

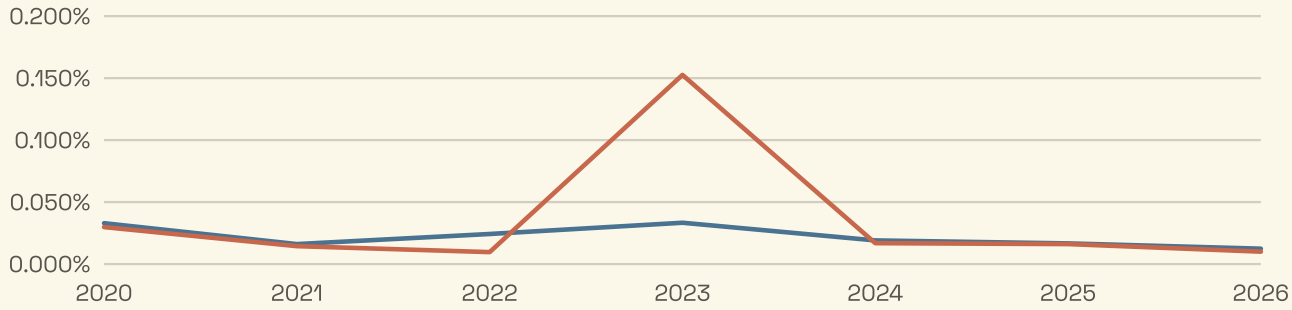
How we know

Google's estimates through DataForSEO for one Latin name form held fixed (estimate). The ratios are ours (derived). A search is not a fan.

FINDING 5: READING AND LIKES

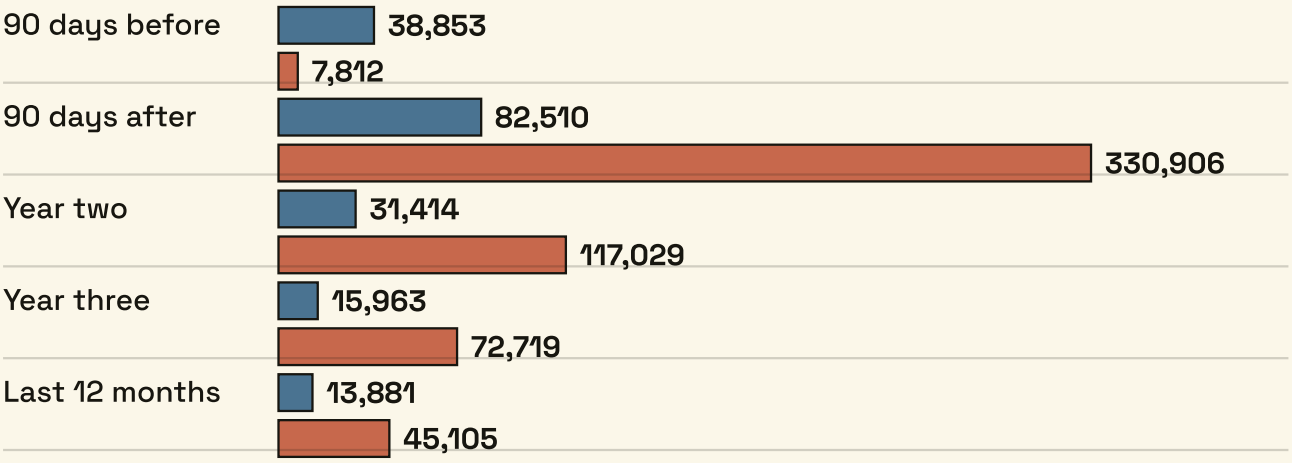
Daily reading went back. Likes rose and fell at both clubs.

Each club page's share of Arabic Wikipedia, every September



Blue is Al Hilal and terracotta Al Nassr. September 2026 reads 0.012% for Al Hilal and 0.010% for Al Nassr. Al Hilal sits below each September of 2020 to 2022. Al Nassr sits below 2020 and 2021 and level with 2022.

Median likes per post, all formats, on the frozen feed



Windows are counted from each club's own star signing. Likes are read as they stood on 2 November 2026, so older posts have had longer to collect them.



28 January 2025. 2,091,314 likes. Al Hilal's farewell video. Its median post reads 38,518 in the 90 days before his exit and 20,185 in the 90 after: a date, with no share given to him.



FINDING 5: THE TEST

Six rival explanations, each read against the data.

Competing explanation	What the data show
November 2022 is a flattering base	Every series starts then, so its fairness cannot be told. The headline comparison was changed to September against September and year against year
The rise is the league's	In India Al Ittihad reads 37.95 times and Al Ahli 16.88 times November 2022, against Al Hilal's 13.70. These multiples are not the two clubs' alone
One or two big months drive it	Al Nassr's rise leans on May 2026, its largest month in five of six countries. Without each span's top month it reads 0.99 to 1.13 times, and Al Hilal's still 0.35 to 0.89
Google regrouped spellings	Name forms are held fixed, and no older vintage exists to test a regrouping. Unknown
Wikimedia's March 2025 reclassing	At the boundary Al Hilal, Al Ittihad and Al Ahli read 0.70 to 0.80 of their prior 28 days and Al Nassr 0.93. No clean step, so the fall is neither explained away nor cleanly separated
More posts pull the median down	Both clubs now post 6.6 to 6.9 times a day, against 1.8 to 3.7 before. Likes a day hold the direction: Al Nassr 25,033 before and 861,312 now; Al Hilal 214,193 and 164,063, a fall of 0.77 times against 0.36 on the median

VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY

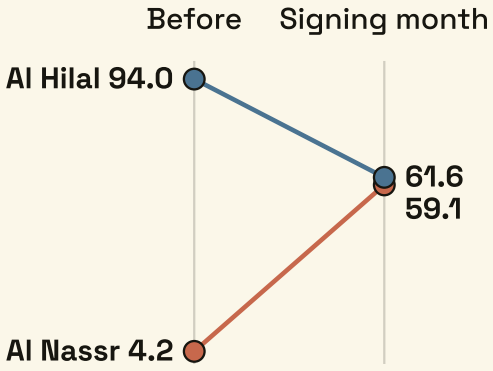
What stays depends on the ruler. No multiple here is a signing effect or a count of retained fans, and the September fade is search for a name form, not people leaving.

FINDING 7: WHOSE AUDIENCE

The two signing months land at the same ratio by opposite routes.

Arabic Wikipedia views of the club's page for every 100 views of its star's page. Ronaldo's Instagram, 679,856,205 followers, is about 22.5 times Al Nassr's 30,229,698.

Before and in the signing month



Three years on, 28-day ruler



Al Nassr climbed from 4.2 to 59.1 views per 100 of Ronaldo's. Al Hilal fell from 94.0 to 61.6 per 100 of Neymar's. On days when player and club both posted the same format, Ronaldo names the club in 1 of 112 videos, 4 of 111 photos and 24 of 296 carousels, and tags it or shares authorship in 6, 22 and 166. Neymar, to 28 January 2025, names his in 1 of 39, 1 of 32 and 4 of 99, and tags it in 2, 1 and 3.

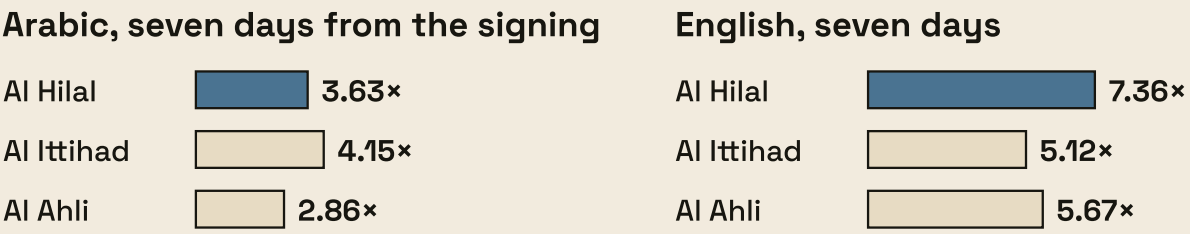
Test. The same ratio was read before, at and three years after nine moves. The denominators drive much of it: Ronaldo's before-window sits on the World Cup, and Neymar's page fell away after he left. No file links a reader of one page to a reader of the other.

> VERDICT: FAILS
>
> The claim that readers came for the club, or for the man, does not survive. What holds is narrower: the ratios describe where page requests went, and they moved opposite ways for the two clubs.

FINDING 8: DID ONE CLUB'S SIGNING LIFT THE OTHER?

Al Hilal's rise in Ronaldo's week sits inside its neighbours'.

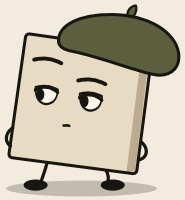
On 31 December 2022 Al Hilal's Arabic page read 6,391, about 5.5 times its baseline, the same day Al Nassr's read 33,802. The tempting story is that one signing lifted the rival.



Al Ittihad and Al Ahli signed nobody that week. Over 30 days Al Hilal's Arabic page reads 2.84 times against 3.89 and 2.68.

In English Al Hilal reads 7.36 against 5.12 and 5.67, a margin of 1.97 points, and 3.86 against 2.86 and 2.82 over 30 days. That margin has no clean comparison behind it: all four clubs' English pages peaked on the same day, after the World Cup and five days after the Riyadh derby. Around Neymar, Al Nassr's Arabic page reads 1.48 against 2.60 and 2.01.

> VERDICT: FAILS
>
> Two clubs rising on shared dates is an observation. The earlier reading of 2.7 to 11.2 times stays withdrawn as a finding. Nor do these data show there was no spillover.





PART SIX: WHERE THEY ARE READ

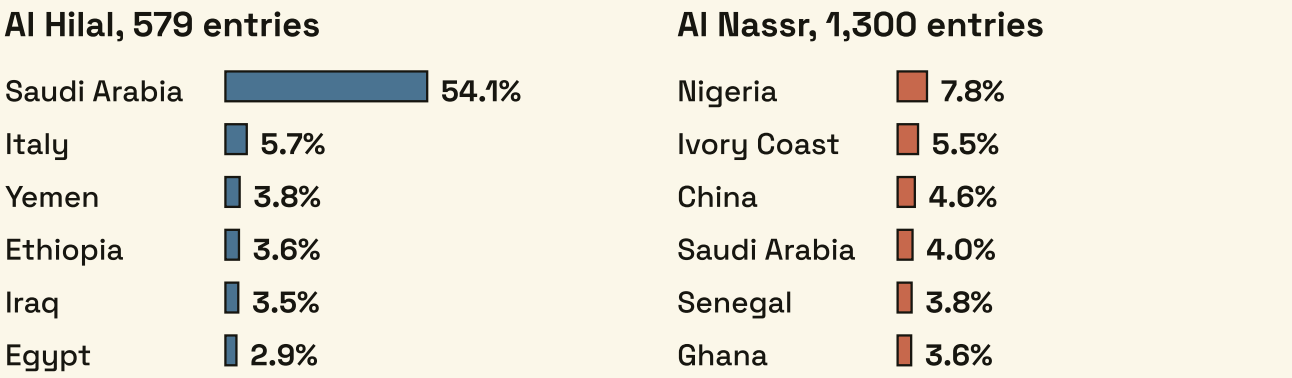
Two homes.

One club's sampled TikTok audience is mostly labelled Saudi, and the other's is spread across dozens of countries. Neither sample proves where fans live.

FINDING 11: TWO AUDIENCE SAMPLES

54% of one sample is labelled Saudi. 4% of the other is.

Country labels in one vendor's TikTok audience samples, read 2 November 2026. The six largest labels for each club.



Google searches, September 2026	Al Nassr	Al Hilal
India	2,240,000	74,000
Brazil	1,000,000	550,000
Indonesia	823,000	201,000

Test. An earlier saved pull shows the same gap, 338 of 596 and 54 of 1,298, with rank agreement across countries of 0.92 for Al Hilal and 0.86 for Al Nassr. All 9 of 9 results for each club's name in India are about the clubs. Search against the TikTok labels agrees for Al Nassr at about 0.46 and does not for Al Hilal, at about −0.10 to −0.24, over 17 to 19 countries. The saved vendor page gives no sampling frame, weights or location method.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY
>
> The gap repeats between pulls, and search leans the same way for Al Nassr. It describes two samples and a search estimate, not where each club's fans live, and no share of the searches is given to Ronaldo.

THE EIGHT-AREA PANEL

Four clubs on eight areas. Most ratings are withheld, and the reasons are kept.

Area and measure	Al Hilal	Al Nassr	Al Ittihad	Al Ahli	Status
Awareness: Google topic interest in Saudi Arabia, 53-week mean	22.87	18.77	11.43	9.68	Rated
Being found: fan queries where an official page is first, Saudi Arabia	50.0%	18.8%	43.8%	37.5%	Withheld: match-day condition not certified
AI answers: replies naming the club, ChatGPT	100%	100%	79.2%	75.0%	Withheld: naming at its ceiling
Reputation: positive share of opinionated comments on the club's own videos	93.1%	96.1%	75.0%	58.8%	Fan talk, not fact. Two clubs below the sample floor
Social presence: median views per YouTube upload	18,890	51,712	20,528	12,208	Rated where complete
Site: mobile performance score, home page	36	41	77	51	Withheld: checks incomplete
Distinctiveness	Colour, type and logo read; claims not read as a set				Not rated
Fit	The most frequent fan request is not established				Not rated

How we know

The study's scorecard of 2 November 2026. Topic interest is a relative index within one pull (derived). Search and site checks are measured on fixed panels. Comment tone is coded by Jev and spot-read by hand; it describes fan talk on each club's own channel, which favours warm audiences. No composite score is formed, because no tested way to combine the areas exists.

FINDING 19: BEING FOUND AND BEING NAMED

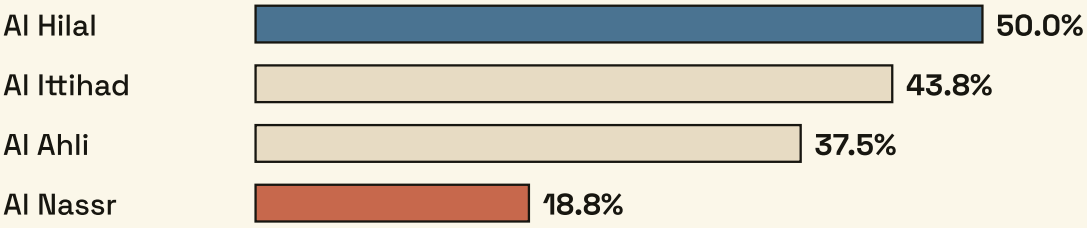
AI assistants name both clubs almost every time, so naming does not separate them.

Eight fixed fan questions in Arabic and English, asked three times on each engine. A reply counts if it names the club.



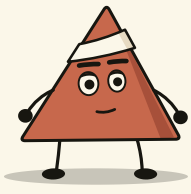
Outside Arabic and English, in five more languages, Al Hilal is named in 54 of 54 complete replies and Al Nassr in 53 of 54. Jev agreed with hand codes on 1,625 of 1,632 fields, which is agreement on coding, not on truth. Six Gemini Portuguese re-asks returned an error on the frozen language code, so the route's integration check stays failed and no rating is written.

Fan queries where an official page ranks first, Saudi Arabia



VERDICT: HOLDS, AS A COUNT OF BEING NAMED

On these questions naming sits at its ceiling for both clubs. It says nothing about accuracy, citation or recommendation, and no assistant is used here as a source of any fact.





PART SEVEN: GROUND AND SCREEN

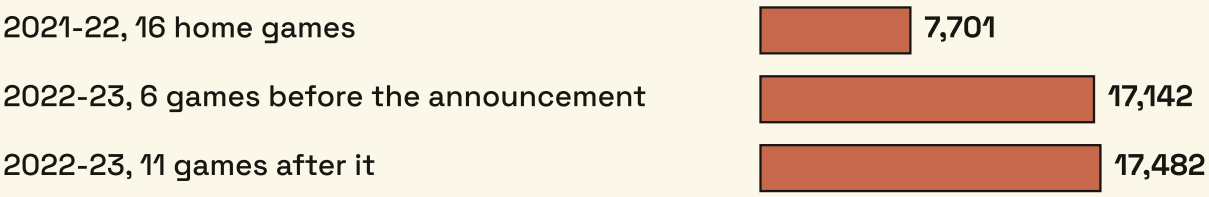
The journey.

Crowds, trips, films and headlines: the evidence that leaves the screen. Each one is told on the record, and none of it is counted.

FINDING 12: REPORTED CROWDS

Al Nassr's reported crowds had doubled before Ronaldo was announced.

Median reported home crowd at the same ground, by span. The step up came before 30 December 2022, and the median did not step again after it.



Same league opponent at home	2021-22	2022-23, before the announcement	Difference
Al Hilal	11,913	23,248	11,335
Al Ittihad	14,619	23,025	8,406
Damac	7,997	14,972	6,975
Al Fayha	0, as the source prints it	12,763	12,763

Without the derby the medians read 7,338 and 14,972. Al Hilal's median moved the other way over the same span, 12,731.5 to 8,138.5, on other grounds. Whether 2021-22 ran under crowd limits stays unknown: 1,225 saved text files gave no answer. Capacity is blank in all 1,009 calendar rows, so a full ground cannot be told from flat demand.

> VERDICT: HOLDS NARROWLY, AS A DATED OBSERVATION
>
> It is not a finding about the signing in either direction. Crowd rules, capacity and independent gate counts are unknown, and three matches tried at a second source could not be verified.

FINDING 12: THE GROUND ITSELF

One ground under two names, filled four days before the announcement.



26 December 2022. Al Nassr's own photo from the derby day at Mrsool Park, four days before the announcement: well-filled stands, the crest on the big screen, no scoreboard. A filled ground, not a count. Its caption stays off this page.



Al-Awwal Park, the operator's page, undated. Mrsool Park and Al-Awwal Park are one physical ground. No crowd shown.



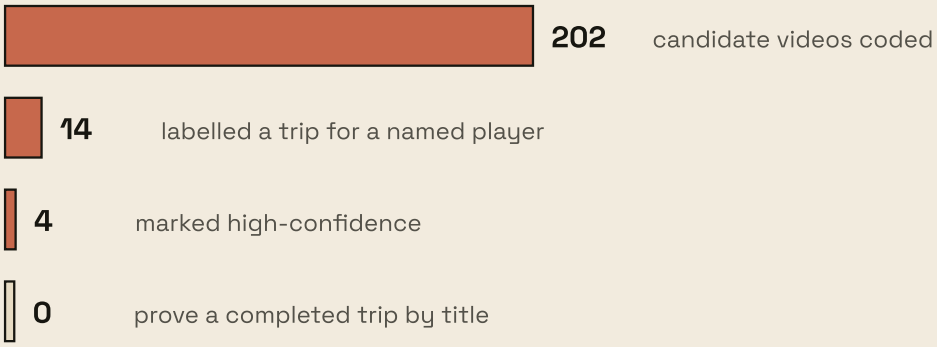
Kingdom Arena, Al Hilal's page, undated. An empty pitch and lit stands. No crowd shown.

The reported crowds behind Finding 12 come mostly from Wikipedia match pages, one route of sources, and capacity is blank in every calendar row. These pictures place the grounds and date one filled stand; they count no one.

FINDING 13: TRIPS TO SEE A STAR

Journeys are told and sold. The chain breaks before a count.

Each link from a told trip to a counted visitor was walked. The count falls to none at the step where a trip is shown to have happened.



Coded candidate videos. Of the 14 positive labels, 11 name Ronaldo, 1 Neymar and 2 more than one player. Read by title alone, none of the 14 proves a completed trip from abroad, and one is the combined Riyadh side's match.

What exists

Press cases that narrow when opened: one trip names no departure point, one group went to Abha and Abu Dhabi and not Riyadh. An advertised Riyadh package for 6 to 10 May 2026 at USD 2,649 offers a match ticket, four hotel nights and local transport, with no airfare.

What is missing

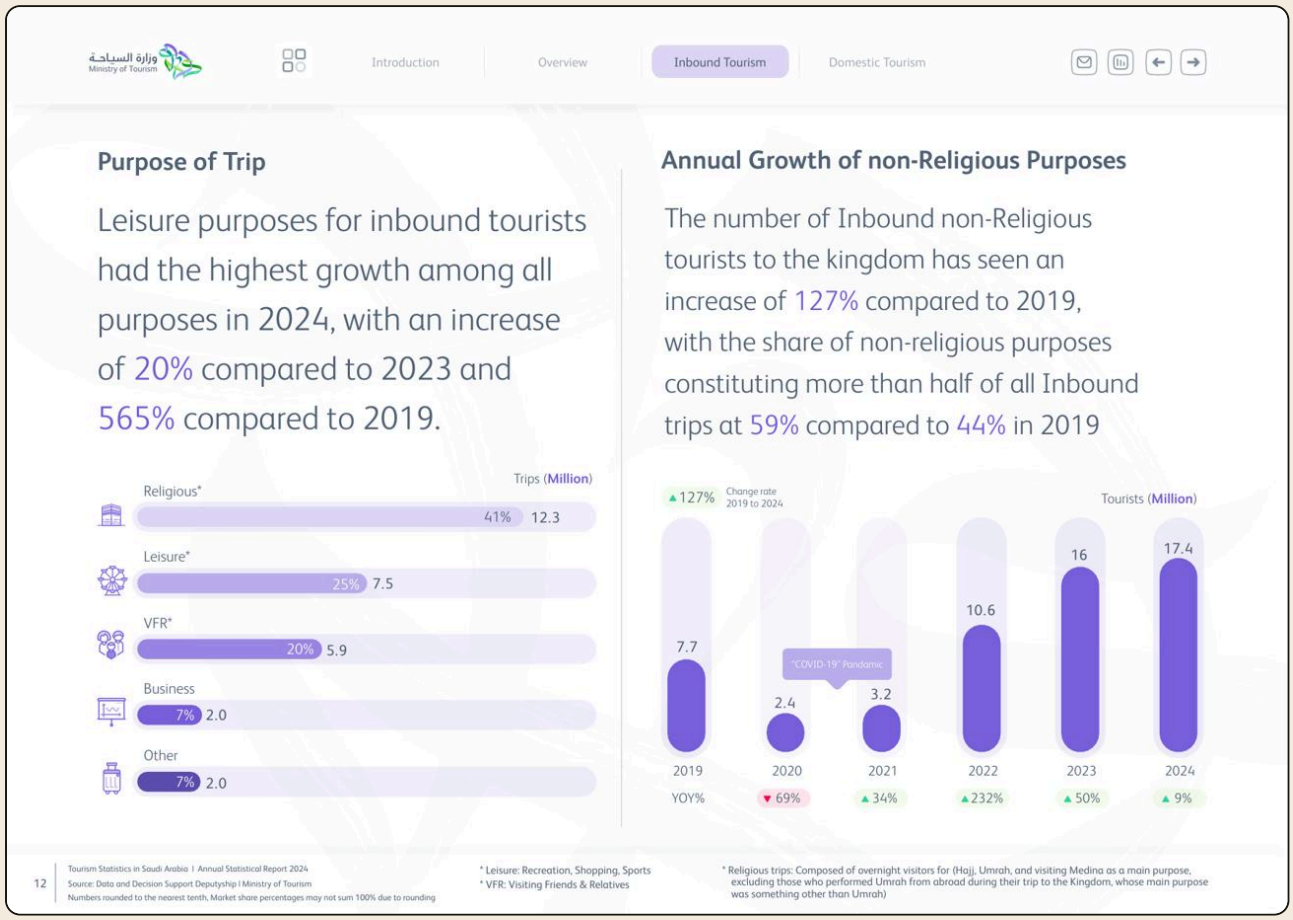
The Ministry of Tourism reports 29.7 million inbound overnight visitors in 2024 for all purposes, with no football line. Of 636 stadium reviews, none states both a trip from abroad and a reason to watch. Inbound visits rose from 1,840,021 in November 2022 to 2,390,726 in December, before the signing.

VERDICT: HOLDS AS CASES

Such journeys are told, sold and reported. How many people came because of a star stays unknown, and the aggregate data cannot settle it.

FINDING 13: THE RECORD BEHIND THE JOURNEYS

A welcome on the street, and no football line in the count.



Ministry of Tourism, Annual Statistical Report 2024, page 12. Trips by purpose. Sport sits inside "Leisure" with recreation and shopping; football has no line of its own.



3 January 2023. A "Hala Ronaldo" billboard in Riyadh. AFP, via The National.

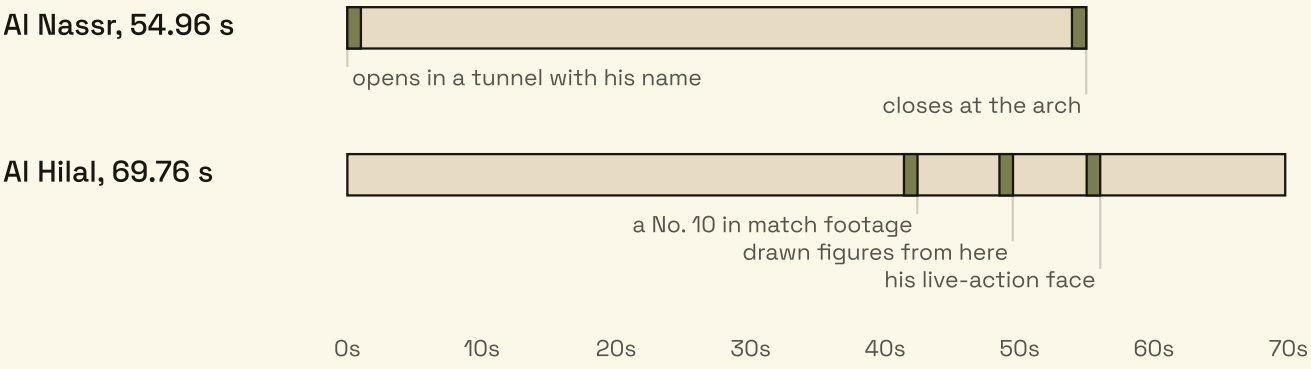
The Ministry of Tourism reports 29.7 million inbound overnight visitors in 2024, for all purposes. Its chart of purposes folds sport into leisure, so no football figure can be read from it. The billboard is the city's dated welcome to one player; it counts no visitor.

> WHAT THE PICTURES CAN CARRY
>
> A date and a place for the story of single journeys. Not a number of football tourists.

FINDINGS 14 AND 15: ON SCREEN

One film is about the man from its first frame. The other shows him near the end.

The two arrival films on one time axis, read from cut frames with no audio heard. Olive marks the moments named below.



Al Nassr's 54.96-second ceremony excerpt opens inside a tunnel printed with his name and closes at a "Welcome CR7" arch. Al Hilal's 69.76-second film builds a montage of Saudi settings, football and supporters. A player numbered 10 in a navy shirt appears in match footage at about 41.4 to 42.4 seconds with no face readable. Drawn figures follow from about 48.5 seconds, and his live-action face at about 0:55. That the No. 10 is Neymar is an inference.

Finding 15. A Visit Saudi film of 1 September 2025 shows Ronaldo in the white Al Nassr kit with its marks at about 22.3 to 23 seconds and ends on the campaign's address. The other way, the club's 3 January 2023 unveiling carries the national "Welcome to Arabia" mark beside its own on the tunnel and arch. His post of the campaign carries #Ad.

VERDICT 14: HOLDS NARROWLY

For these two pieces, as what is on screen. Not a pattern, and no intent is read.

VERDICT 15: HOLDS

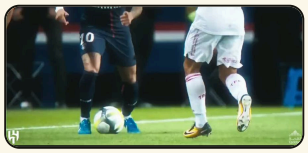
As what is on screen. What travels back to the club's brand is untested.



0:01. Al Nassr: the tunnel with his name.



0:54. Al Nassr: the "Welcome CR7" arch.



0:42. Al Hilal: a No. 10 in navy, no face, no name.



0:57. Al Hilal: his face, from about 0:55.

FINDING 15: MARKS ON SCREEN

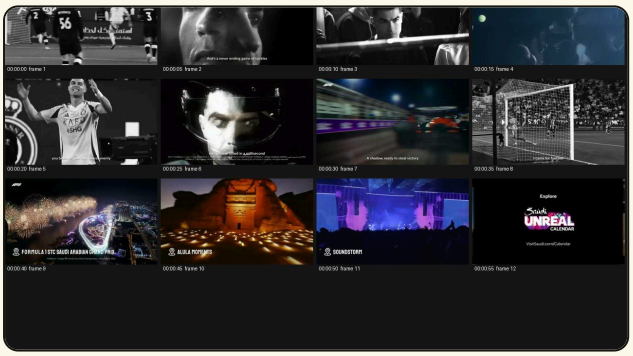
A club kit inside a national campaign. A national mark inside a club ceremony.



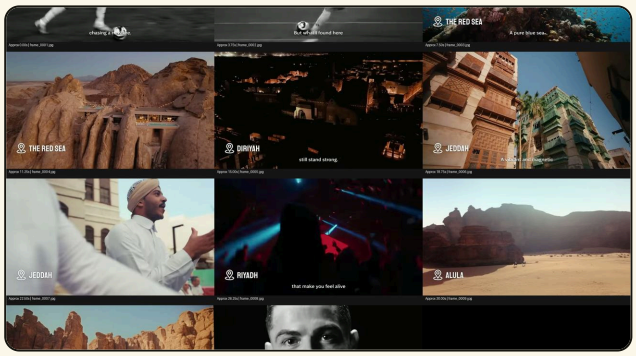
3 January 2023. Riyadh's "Hala Ronaldo" billboards carry the club's crest and the Saudi mark. The National.



3 January 2023. The unveiling: the "Saudi / Welcome to Arabia" mark beside the crest on the tunnel and the arch. Al Nassr's YouTube.



1 September 2025. 62 seconds. 255,406 views. Visit Saudi's "Unreal Calendar": the white Al Nassr kit with crest, KAFD and SHG at about 22 seconds; the end card is VisitSaudi.com/Calendar.



16 December 2025. 45 seconds. 25,842,647 views. The same marks at about 5.5 seconds, five labelled destinations and a package address.

Neither Visit Saudi film names the club in a caption or end card, and no Al Nassr post in the frozen set carries the campaign's name. The two view counters were read at different ages and are not comparable. The club's National Day film is not shown, because its frames hold a child and a trophy.

> THE FILM MAY SAY, AND MAY NOT
>
> It may show the frame with crest, kit sponsors and a national calendar together, as a dated campaign fact with publisher and date. It reads no purpose into it and states no effect.

FINDING 18: THE WORLD'S PRESS

Some of the press introduced each club through its star. How common that was is unknown.

Step	Count	What it allows
Pages captured	130	A search, not a census
Dated non-match originals kept	57, in nine languages: 33 Al Hilal, 21 Al Nassr, 3 Al Ittihad	Examples that exist
Originals reopened by an independent reader	5, and a headline pair per language	Four read as described, one narrowed, one date corrected
Hand and Jev agree on the frame	10 of 13 pilot articles	Too low to publish automated shares
Hand and Jev agree on the speaker	6 of 13	Shares withheld

ge and O Globo introduce Al Hilal through Neymar, then explain the club's name, history and rivals. TV5MONDE's profile of 3 January 2023 builds Al Nassr as a club known at home and unknown abroad. Footpack frames the kit supplier's deal through Ronaldo and measures no shirt sales.

Competing explanation. The articles were picked, so the study found what it looked for; the clubs' counts are unequal; a transfer report naturally leads with the player. The shared news archive refused the request and a dated citation pull returned 160 empty dates, so the selection explanation stays open.

> VERDICT: HOLDS AS EXAMPLES
>
> For these readers abroad the star was the door to the club. No share of any frame, and no movement in it, can be read.

FINDING 18: THE SAME TRANSFER DAY

Two signings, four headlines, two languages.

The same Arabic publisher on both signings, and the Brazilian press on both, as each headline was published. They are examples that exist, not a measure of how common a frame was.

CNN Arabic, 15 August 2023



CNN Arabic, 31 December 2022, the day after the event



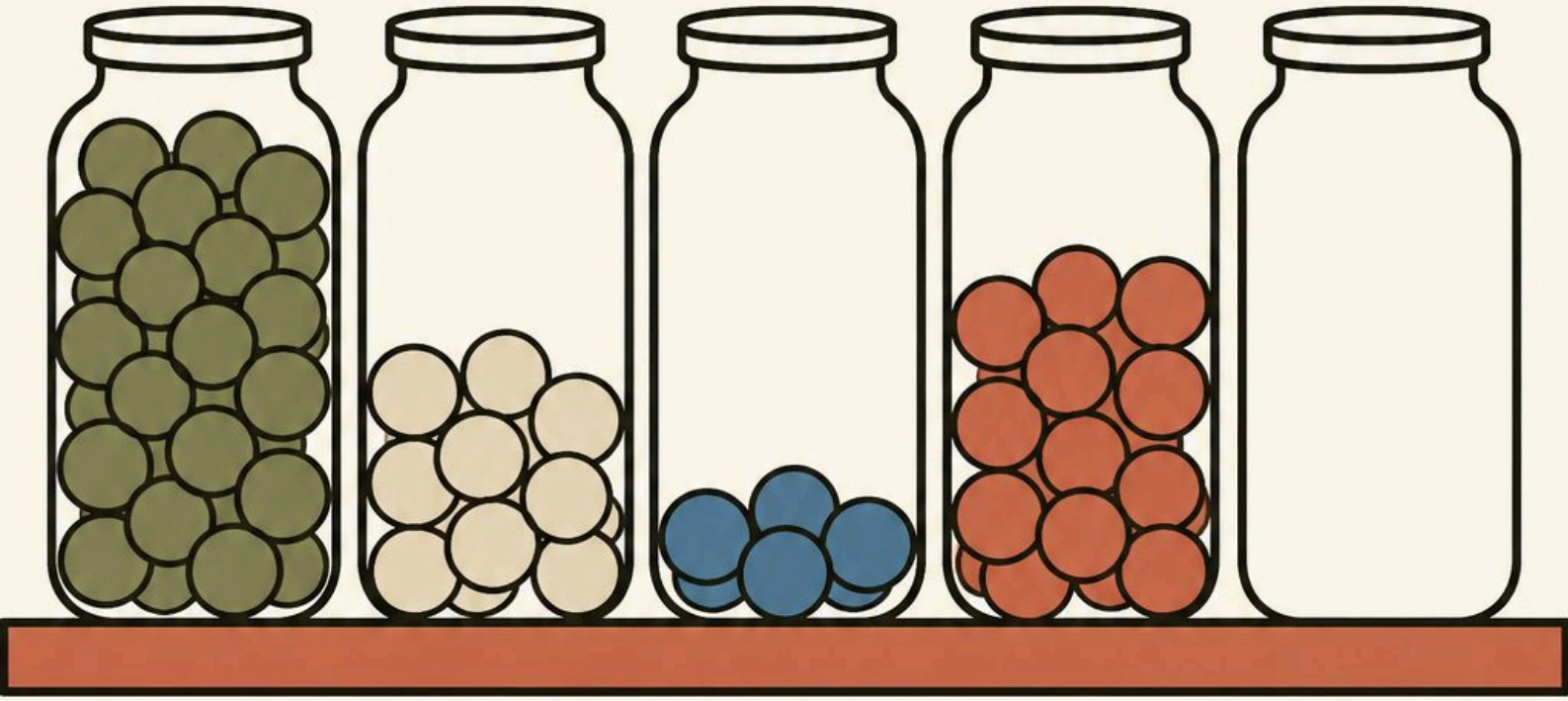
CNN Brasil, 15 August 2023



ge, 30 December 2022



Headline crops only, because a full capture can carry a trophy count further down the page.





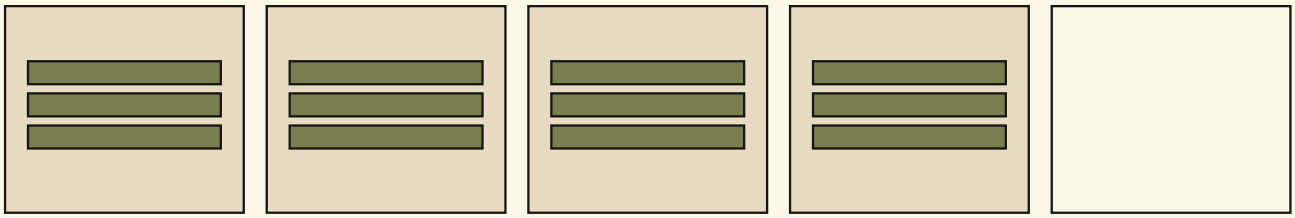
PART EIGHT: MONEY AND THE YEAR AHEAD

Five boxes.

Exposure, modelled value, contracts, revenue and cash are five different things, and they are often quoted as one. The last box is empty for both clubs.

FINDING 17: RANKINGS AND MONEY

The headline numbers do not compare the same thing, and none reaches cash.



Four boxes hold published figures for at least one club. No source gives cash for either.

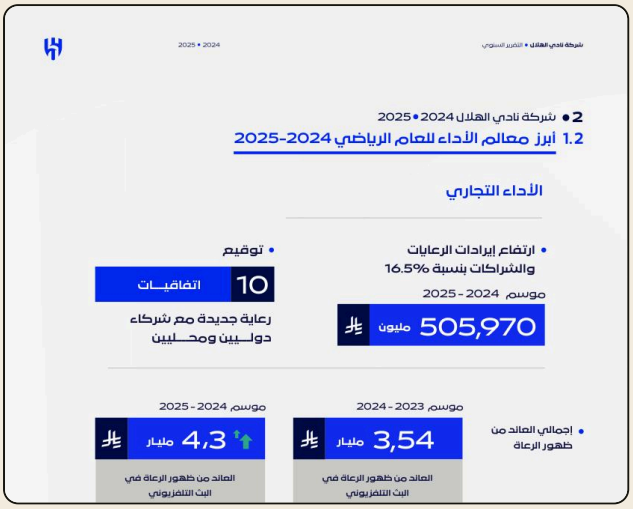
Publisher	What it prints	Why it does not join
Brand Finance, 2024	Brand Strength Index 79.6 and 74.0 in its press release; 74.6 and 70.1 in its report	Same named index, two values, no explanation on either page
Brand Finance, 2025	Al Hilal ahead overall, 80.8 to 75.6; Al Nassr ahead internationally, 69.5 to 57.9	Different respondent bases
Football Benchmark, 2023	43.8 million, a gain of 24.3 million, 487%	43.8 less 24.3 is 19.5, on which 24.3 is 125%. The three are not one pair of endpoints
Al Hilal, 2024/25 report	Revenue SAR1.27bn against SAR1.09bn; 17% commercial growth	Its own amounts give about 11.4%
Al Nassr, 2023/24	SAR615m	A republished company summary. Signed accounts were not found after seven public routes
The league's CARMA reading	USD219.22m	Advertising value for a three-derby week, not income

VERDICT: HOLDS AS A LIMIT

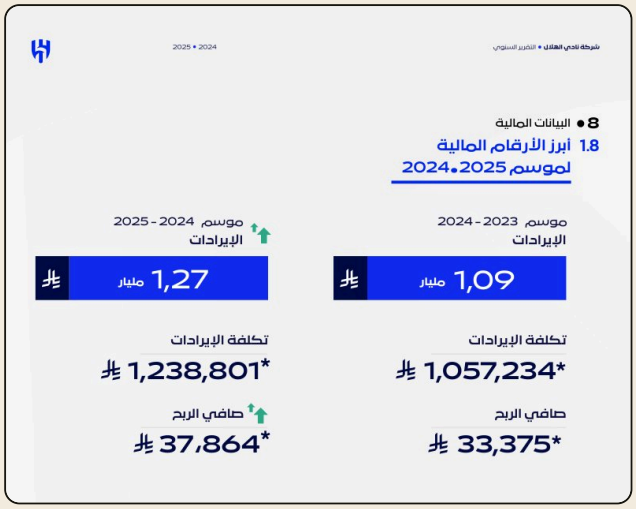
The numbers do not join, and the sources do not reconcile them. No bad intent is established, and no link from attention to cash is established for either club.

FINDING 17: THE PAGES BEHIND THE BOXES

Exposure on one page, revenue on another, and no page for cash.



Al Hilal annual report 2024-25, page 23. SAR4.3bn of sponsor exposure, split 1.6 television and 2.7 social. Exposure, not income.



Page 185. Revenue SAR1.27bn against 1.09bn, net profit SAR37.864m against 33.375m. The report prints 17% commercial growth where its own amounts give about 11.4%. The liquidity lines below are left out.



19 December 2024. Kooora republishes Al Nassr's summary for the year to 30 June 2024: revenue SAR615m, expenses SAR654m. A summary, not signed accounts; the lower panels stay out.

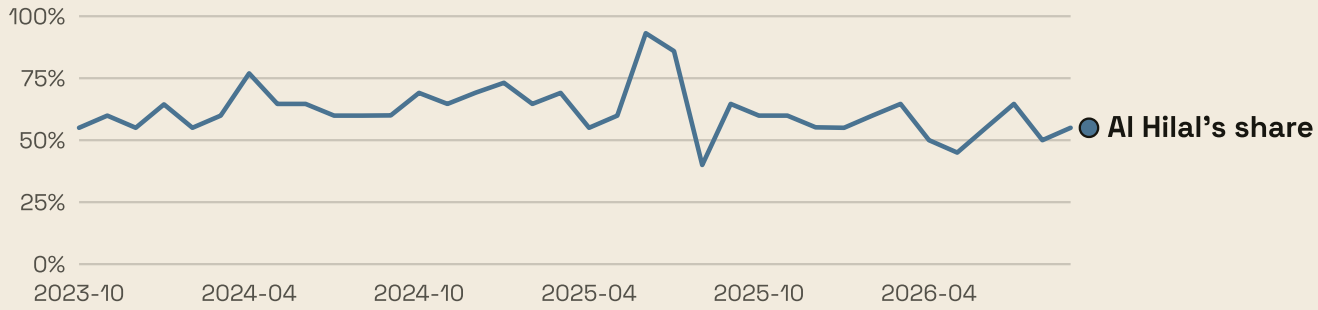
Each figure was reopened at its source. Al Nassr's own accounts were not obtained after seven public routes, and no source gives cash for either club.

THE YEAR AHEAD, AS A BASELINE

At home, repeating last year is the most honest baseline the data allow.

A statistical reading of the next twelve months with no new event in it. It is not a target and not a promise.

Al Hilal's share of Arabic-name search in Saudi Arabia, the two clubs only

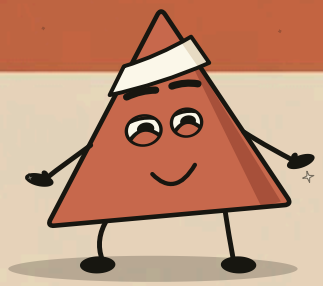


Over the last 12 months the share moved between 45.0% and 64.6% month to month. Neither club holds the home search lead for long.

Searches in Saudi Arabia	Last 12 months	Next 12, published	Method	Error, MASE
Al Hilal, Arabic name	34,572,000	30,522,550	Blend	0.812
Al Nassr, Arabic name	29,130,000	29,130,000	Seasonal repeat	0.636
Al Hilal, Latin name	611,700	577,275	TimesFM	0.666
Al Nassr, Latin name	1,828,700	1,828,700	Seasonal repeat	0.656

Each published method had the lowest mean error across four rolling backtests, twelve months ahead. Ranges held 34 to 40 of 48 points, an optimistic count because the folds overlap. Arabic Wikipedia is not read as a forecast: five printed points sit outside their own printed ranges. An arrival the model does not know about could move any line by an unknown amount. Volumes are Google's estimates (estimate); every forecast value is derived.





PART NINE: WHAT DID NOT HOLD

The limits.

A negative result is part of the study. These are the claims that failed or were withdrawn, and the questions public data cannot answer.

NEGATIVE RESULTS

Eight readings that failed, were withdrawn or were narrowed.

Earlier reading	What the test found	Now
Readers came for the club, or for the star	The ratios move with the star's page. No file links a reader of one page to a reader of the other	Fails (7)
Ronaldo's arrival lifted Al Hilal, 2.7 to 11.2 times	The rise sits inside Al Ittihad's and Al Ahli's in the same week	Withdrawn (8)
Al Hilal's biggest English month was a tournament	On raw views it is fourth, 9,098 a day against Neymar's 31,090. The multiple came from a low base	Reversed (9)
Search abroad stays many times above November 2022	True and flattering. Against the years after the signings, Al Hilal's is lower in all six countries	Replaced (5)
Al Hilal's typical post a year on fell	Adding photo posts moved it from a little below its start to a little above	Near tie (16)
Ronaldo names the club in 3 of 86 videos	Came from another lane's selection. The full feed gives 1 of 112 videos and far more tags in photos	Replaced (7)
Neymar's film spends 54 seconds on places and people	Frames cannot show that. A No. 10 is on screen at 41 seconds	Narrowed (14)
A rating for AI answers	Six Portuguese re-asks failed on the frozen language code. Nothing was relabelled to pass	No rating (19)

The number in brackets is the finding that carries the test.

LIMITS OF THE DATA

Seven questions public data cannot answer, and what would change that.

What the study refuses to claim

1 **How much of any rise a signing alone caused**

Unveilings, matches and other arrivals share every window.

2 **Whose fans these are**

Page ratios describe requests, not people.

3 **How many people travelled for a star**

No count exists in the sources opened.

4 **Whether a star filled the stadium**

Crowd rules, capacity and gate counts are unknown.

5 **How many followers are real people**

Spam cannot be ruled in or out from outside.

6 **That money followed attention**

The cash box is empty for both clubs.

7 **Why Al Hilal holds X**

What does not explain it was found, not what does.

What would change the reading

A daily follower series for both clubs across December 2022 to February 2023, or a publisher's raw export of the crossing.

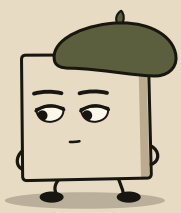
A dated, independent gate count for Al Nassr's home games of 2021-22 and 2022-23, or that season's crowd rules.

A complete calendar with every match date readable, if it moved Ronaldo's window off first place.

Search history before November 2022, or an older vintage of Google's spelling groups.

Likes at a fixed post age, or photo posts older than December 2022.

A public panel that follows the same person across a star's page and a club's.



Five things the study stands behind.

1 **Ronaldo's window is a jump the calendar does not explain**

About 12 times in Arabic and 15 in English over 30 days, first among stretches with a like calendar. Neymar's Arabic month is less distinctive.

2 **The follower order reversed by June 2023, except on X**

Instagram and TikTok carry most of the swing. Al Hilal leads X in every observed comparison.

3 **What stays depends on the ruler**

Followers stay high, search abroad parts ways, daily reading goes back, and likes rise and fall.

4 **The biggest month depends on the language**

In English it is the star's arrival, in Arabic a run of football. Ronaldo's move leads nine on Arabic and Spanish views over 28 days.

5 **Public figures conflict, and none reaches cash**

Publishers disagree with themselves, and the assistants' naming sits at its ceiling.

Who leads each ruler in 2026

	Al Hilal	Level	Al Nassr
All followers, May 2026	○	○	●
Instagram	○	○	●
TikTok	○	○	●
Facebook	○	○	●
X	●	○	○
Search abroad, six countries	○	○	●
Arabic Wikipedia, page views	○	●	○
Search in Saudi Arabia, Arabic name	●	○	○
Search in Saudi Arabia, Latin name	○	○	●



APPENDIX A: FOLLOWERS

Four tables, four platforms, both clubs.

CIES Football Observatory's tables as reported, June 2023 to May 2026. YouTube is left out because the first two tables do not carry it.

Club and table	X	Instagram	Facebook	TikTok	Four platforms
Al Hilal, Jun 2023	12,993,483	3,900,000	980,000	2,100,000	19,973,483
Al Hilal, Jun 2024	14,161,000	10,603,000	2,700,000	5,300,000	32,764,000
Al Hilal, Jun 2025	14,310,633	10,945,902	3,400,000	6,600,000	35,256,535
Al Hilal, May 2026	12,200,000	10,070,000	3,900,000	7,300,000	33,470,000
Al Nassr, Jun 2023	5,196,215	14,000,000	2,729,146	10,300,000	32,225,361
Al Nassr, Jun 2024	5,973,000	25,943,000	5,600,000	16,800,000	54,316,000
Al Nassr, Jun 2025	6,217,444	27,782,474	6,300,000	18,900,000	59,199,918
Al Nassr, May 2026	5,830,000	29,200,000	8,100,000	20,000,000	63,130,000

The frozen feed, around each star's arrival

Window	Al Nassr posts	Al Nassr median likes	Al Hilal posts	Al Hilal median likes
30 days before	137	7,720	148	40,736
30 days after	155	495,925	209	131,114
Days 30 to 89	264	217,701	359	63,340
A year on	163	166,222	200	45,292

How we know

Followers are measured, as each table printed them; the four-platform sums are ours. Post counts and medians are derived from the frozen set of 2 November 2026, on UTC dates: Al Nassr around 30 December 2022, Al Hilal around 15 August 2023. On Riyadh dates Al Hilal's before window holds 149 posts with a median of 40,188.

APPENDIX B: NINE MOVES

Each move on the Arabic ruler of Finding 10.

The club's Arabic Wikipedia page, a 28-day baseline ending 28 days before the event, against the 28 days from it. The multiple is read on each page's share of the edition.

Move	Baseline, views a day	28 days, views a day	Multiple
Ronaldo, Al Nassr	959	10,869	13.52×
Messi, Miami	52	7,096	136.78×
Neymar, Al Hilal	1,255	3,528	2.75×
Messi, PSG	510	3,300	6.44×
Ronaldo, United	632	3,159	4.85×
Benzema, Al Ittihad	1,954	2,390	1.27×
Ronaldo, Juventus	589	2,251	3.90×
Mbappe, Madrid	32,147	1,590	0.07×
Neymar, PSG	215	1,345	6.32×

Sensitivity: with 14-, 28- and 56-day baselines and events, Ronaldo to Al Nassr holds the Arabic count at 28 days in every complete cell. At 14 days Messi to Miami leads in Arabic. Messi to Miami holds the multiple throughout.



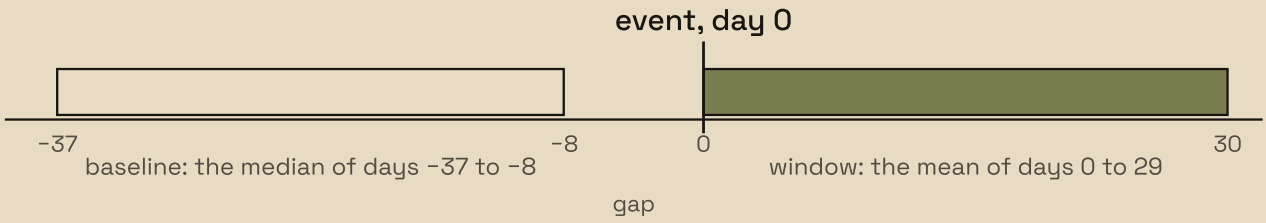
25 July 2023. Al Nassr's 2023-24 home shirt, the first season after Ronaldo arrived. Footy Headlines.



23 June 2023. Al Hilal's 2023-24 home shirt, published seven weeks before Neymar signed. Footy Headlines.

APPENDIX C: TERMS

The words of this study, defined once.



The window multiple in one drawing: the mean of the window divided by the median of the baseline.

Baseline	The median daily page views from 37 to 8 days before an event, unless a finding names another.
Window multiple	Mean daily views over the window, divided by the baseline.
Share of edition	A page's views as a share of all views in its Wikipedia edition. It holds out the edition's growth and Wikimedia's traffic changes.
Like stretch	A 30-day stretch of a club's history with about the same mix of match days as the window it is compared with.
Frozen set	Every post on each club's Instagram, read once at 07:45 UTC on 2 November 2026.
Median post	The middle post by likes in a window. Likes a day are also read, because posting more pulls a median down.
Search estimate	Google's monthly search volume for one fixed name form, rounded by Google into coarse steps.
Relative index	Google's daily or weekly interest, scaled within one pull. It compares inside that pull only.
Rank agreement	Spearman's correlation between two orderings of countries, from −1 to 1.
MASE	A forecast's mean absolute error scaled by the training period's seasonal changes. Lower is better.
Holds narrowly	The reading survives its test with a named qualification, printed in its verdict.



ZQ3S

Attention, measured.

A study of Al Hilal and Al Nassr online, from the data saved on 2 November 2026. It reads attention, judges no club and advises no one.

